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UPSC NEETI
CIVIL SERVICES STRATEGY

ETHICS, INTEGRITY AND APTITUDE

73 Core Terminologies

Memory hook · Definition · Keywords · Quotes
Personal · Administrative · Contemporary · International examples
Recall and revision section at the end

GENERAL STUDIES PAPER IV · CIVIL SERVICES MAINS

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HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Every term is set out the same way. The structure is the point: in the ethics paper a definition earns a mark or two, and the example at the right level earns the rest.

BAND	WHAT IT IS FOR
MEMORY HOOK	The one line that makes the term stick. Read it first, recall it last.
DEFINITION	One or two lines. Open your answer with it, then move on.
KEYWORDS	The words to actually put on the page. Examiners look for them.
QUOTES	One per answer, placed where it carries the argument — not as decoration.
PERSONAL EXAMPLES	Individual conduct, and case studies asking what you would do.
ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES	Officers, institutions, laws, schemes, failures. The layer most scripts are thin on.
CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES	Mostly 2020 onwards. This is what separates a live answer from a scripted one.
INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES	For comparison and the global dimension. Use one, not three.

The colour of a band is the same everywhere in this book. After a few pages you will stop reading the labels and start navigating by colour, which is the point of them.

THREE RULES WORTH KEEPING

- Examples are evidence, not ornament. One example, deployed and briefly explained, beats four names in a list.
- Contemporary examples are perishable. Verify a figure or a pending case before you use it, and keep adding your own as the news gives them to you.
- In a case study the theory exists to justify the decision. The decision still has to be yours.

HOW TO REVISE THIS

Read a section, then go straight to the Rapid Revision table at the end and cover the right-hand columns. If you cannot produce the core idea and one example from the term name alone, you have read it, not learnt it. The Active Recall tracker at the very end is built for three passes — day 1, day 7, day 21.

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FOUNDATIONAL VALUES

The values the paper keeps returning to. Every case study is one of these under pressure.

1. Aptitude · 2. Integrity · 3. Intellectual Integrity · 4. Probity · 5. Honesty · 6. Objectivity · 7. Impartiality · 8. Non-Partisanship · 9. Tolerance · 10. Courage And Fearlessness · 11. Fortitude · 12. Conscience · 13. Crisis Of Conscience · 14. Dedication To Public Service · 15. Altruism · 16. Forbearance · 17. Trustworthiness And Public Trust · 18. Sportsmanship · 19. Duty Vs Obligation

1 APTITUDE

> Intelligence gets you the marks. Aptitude gets the decision right at 2 a.m.

DEFINITION The ability to apply knowledge well, not merely to hold it. Intelligence is the capacity to acquire knowledge; aptitude is the judgment to use it correctly under real conditions. For a civil servant, it is the natural and trained capacity to perform a role well.

KEYWORDS **application over possession · judgment · competence · Mission Karmayogi**

QUOTES

- *"Vision without action is merely a dream." — Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam*
- *"Talent hits a target no one else can hit; genius hits a target no one else can see." — Arthur Schopenhauer*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An LBSNAA trainee who stays calm in a mock crisis drill and works the problem logically instead of freezing.
- An aspirant who converts years of self-study into structured, composed answers under real exam pressure.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Mission Karmayogi (2020) and the iGOT platform shifted civil-service training from rule-memorisation to role-competency — behavioural, functional and domain aptitude.
- Aptitude without ethics is dangerous: Dr. Kalam and Dr. A.Q. Khan are the standard contrast, and the Harshad Mehta scam shows sharp financial skill with no moral anchor.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- ISRO's Chandrayaan-3 soft landing (23 August 2023) came from applying the failure analysis of Chandrayaan-2 — knowledge converted into corrected judgment, which is exactly aptitude.
- In an age where facts are one search away, aptitude increasingly means judgment in ambiguity: knowing which data to trust and when an algorithm's answer must be overruled.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Singapore's civil-service selection tests judgment under pressure rather than recall.
- Finland recruits teachers on aptitude and disposition, not marks alone.

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2 INTEGRITY

> Integrity is what your file says when nobody will ever read it.

DEFINITION Consistency between belief, word and action across time and place — holding to principle even when nobody is watching and when it costs something. It is wholeness of character, not merely the absence of corruption.

KEYWORDS wholeness of character · consistency · no-audience test

QUOTES

- *"Integrity is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching." — C.S. Lewis*
- *"In looking for people to hire, you look for integrity, intelligence and energy. And if they do not have the first, the other two will kill you." — Warren Buffett (UPSC 2018)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Ashok Khemka, transferred over 50 times as an IAS officer, held to his position each time rather than trade it for a comfortable posting.
- A junior engineer who refuses to sign an inflated measurement book, knowing his confirmation may be delayed for it.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Dr. Satish Dhawan publicly owned the 1979 satellite launch failure himself instead of letting his team carry the blame.
- Lal Bahadur Shastri resigned as Railway Minister accepting moral responsibility for a rail accident — the benchmark of ministerial integrity.
- The All India Services (Conduct) Rules, 1968 make integrity a service obligation, not an optional virtue.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- ISRO chairman S. Somanath publicly set out exactly what had failed in Chandrayaan-2 and what was changed for Chandrayaan-3, rather than managing the narrative.
- The Supreme Court struck down the electoral bonds scheme (February 2024) and required disclosure of donor data — institutional integrity chosen over administrative convenience.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Kenyan runner Abel Mutai stopped short of the line by mistake; his rival Ivan Fernandez refused to overtake and guided him to the finish.
- Anthonius Agung, an Indonesian air-traffic controller, stayed at his post during the 2018 Palu earthquake to clear a flight for take-off, and died when the tower collapsed.

3 INTELLECTUAL INTEGRITY

> The willingness to be proved wrong — in public, at your own cost.

DEFINITION Loyalty to truth and to sound reasoning above loyalty to one's own past position — the willingness to revise a conclusion when the evidence changes, and to admit error publicly.

KEYWORDS truth over ego · revision on evidence · falsifiability

QUOTES

- *"An unexamined life is not worth living." — Socrates (UPSC 2019)*

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- *"It is the mark of an educated mind to entertain a thought without accepting it." — Aristotle*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A researcher who issues a correction to his own published paper after finding a data error, instead of quietly hoping nobody checks.
- An officer who withdraws a policy note after a subordinate points out a flaw in its assumptions.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Indian courts have overturned their own precedents when constitutional reasoning demanded it — Navtej Johar (2018) undid Suresh Kumar Koushal (2013).
- The Election Commission rewrote its own advisories once online campaigning made the old rules obsolete.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Lancet retracted its own high-profile hydroxychloroquine study (June 2020) when the underlying data could not be verified — science correcting itself in public, at the cost of embarrassment.
- The IPCC's Sixth Assessment cycle (2021–23) revised earlier projections openly as fresh data came in, rather than defending the older numbers.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Scientists who publicly abandoned early COVID-19 positions on masks and airborne transmission once the evidence turned.
- Karl Popper's principle of falsifiability made the willingness to be proved wrong the test of a genuine claim.

4 PROBITY

> Not merely above prosecution. Above suspicion.

DEFINITION Uprightness in public life that goes beyond legality — incorruptibility, strict honesty in office, and a refusal even of advantages that are technically permissible. Probity means being above suspicion, not merely above prosecution.

KEYWORDS **incorruptibility · beyond legality · Caesar's wife**

QUOTES

- *"An honest man's word is as good as his bond." — Miguel de Cervantes*
- *"To educate a person in mind and not in morals is to educate a menace to society." — Theodore Roosevelt*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A patwari who keeps land records open to inspection and refuses money to alter an entry.
- Justice A.K. Sikri withdrew consent for a post-retirement tribunal appointment once questions were raised about its timing, invoking the maxim that Caesar's wife must be above suspicion.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The RTI Act, 2005 institutionalised probity by shrinking the space for unexplained discretion.
- The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act requires public servants to declare assets; the Lokpal became functional with the appointment of a chairperson and members.
- The Central Vigilance Commission's preventive vigilance work targets the systems that make graft possible, not just the individuals caught.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

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- The electoral bonds judgment (2024) turned on probity in political funding: anonymity that is lawful can still be corrosive to public life.
- e-procurement through GeM removed the human discretion at the point of purchase, which is where probity most often fails.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Nordic countries top Transparency International's index because probity norms are enforced socially, not only legally.
- Singapore's near-zero tolerance for official gift-taking is the standard Asian benchmark.

5 HONESTY

> The cheapest virtue to praise, the hardest to practise when it costs.

DEFINITION Truthfulness in word and conduct, without deceit or concealment, regardless of whether the truth is convenient. Honesty is the foundation on which integrity and probity are built.

KEYWORDS truthfulness · no deceit · disclosure

QUOTES

- *"Honesty is the first chapter in the book of wisdom." — Thomas Jefferson*
- *"Truth stands, even if there be no public support." — Mahatma Gandhi*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A shopkeeper who returns excess change to a customer who had not noticed the mistake.
- A cashier at a government counter who reports and refunds a citizen's accidental overpayment.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Under Operation Amanat, the Railway Protection Force traces and returns passengers' lost cash, jewellery and phones to their owners.
- An officer who records an inconvenient fact in the file exactly as it stands, knowing it weakens his own recommendation.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Auto-drivers and delivery riders returning phones, cash and laptops left behind are reported almost weekly — everyday honesty in a gig economy where the owner would never trace them.
- During COVID-19, officials who published real case and death figures despite pressure to show a flattering curve chose honesty over image.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Diplomats who disclose unfavourable trade or emissions data honestly, even when it weakens their own negotiating position.
- The 2018 wallet-drop study across 40 countries found most people returned lost wallets with the money untouched.

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6 OBJECTIVITY

> Deciding what is true before deciding what you want to be true.

DEFINITION Deciding on facts and evidence rather than bias, sentiment or preconception — separating what one wishes were true from what the record shows.

KEYWORDS evidence-based · no preconception · facts first

QUOTES

- *"Facts do not cease to exist because they are ignored." — Aldous Huxley*
- *"It is a capital mistake to theorise before one has data." — Arthur Conan Doyle*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An investigator who follows the forensic evidence even when it contradicts a confident public narrative.
- A journalist who reports the strongest version of the case she personally disagrees with.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- MGNREGA social audits force objective verification of muster rolls against work actually done on the ground.
- Selection boards that use structured marking sheets rather than a general impression of the candidate.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Nutrition schemes were redesigned around NFHS-5 (2019–21) findings on stunting and anaemia rather than on assumed progress — data was allowed to overrule the official story.
- In an era of deepfakes and forwarded 'evidence', objectivity now demands verification before belief, not after.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- UN weapons inspectors who report what they find despite pressure from powerful member states.
- President Kennedy's fact-driven handling of the 1962 Cuban Missile Crisis, resisting the demand for an immediate strike.

7 IMPARTIALITY

> Not merely being fair — being visibly, checkably fair.

DEFINITION Treating like cases alike, without favour to caste, religion, wealth, kinship or political affiliation. The test is not only that the officer is unbiased but that a reasonable citizen can see he is.

KEYWORDS like cases alike · natural justice · nemo judex in causa sua

QUOTES

- *"Justice delayed is justice denied." — William E. Gladstone*
- *"Let justice be done though the heavens fall." — Lord Mansfield*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A clerk who processes ration-card applications strictly on eligibility, ignoring recommendation slips from local leaders.
- An examiner who marks a relative's paper only after formally recusing himself and handing it to a colleague.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Election Commission applies the Model Code of Conduct to the ruling party and the opposition alike.

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- Courts hear cases against sitting governments with the same rigour as cases against private citizens.
- The doctrine of natural justice — nemo judex in causa sua — makes impartiality a legal requirement, not merely a moral one.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- During the 2024 general election, the Election Commission issued notices to the presidents of both the ruling and principal opposition parties over campaign speech — the visible symmetry is what sustains trust.
- Regulators such as SEBI and TRAI are judged less on the outcome of a case than on whether the same standard was applied to a large firm and a small one.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- WTO dispute panels are expected to rule the same way between a powerful economy and a weak one.
- The International Court of Justice settles boundary disputes between states of vastly unequal power on identical legal standards.

8 NON-PARTISANSHIP

> Serve the government of the day. Never become its party worker.

DEFINITION The civil servant's duty to remain politically neutral and to serve the government of the day loyally, whichever party holds office, while giving fearless and honest advice.

KEYWORDS **political neutrality · steel frame · fearless advice**

QUOTES

- *"The Indian Civil Service is the steel frame which holds together the political and social structure of India." — David Lloyd George*
- *"A civil servant must be able to say no to the minister and then loyally carry out the decision the minister takes." — Attributed to the Whitehall tradition*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Rajesh Bhushan, as Health Secretary, ran vaccine distribution during COVID-19 on population and caseload criteria, not on which party ruled a state.
- O.P. Chowdhary, as Collector, refused rally permissions to every political party alike during a pollution emergency — the rule applied without exception.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Ajay Singh, as DM of Buxar, conducted an election untouched by local political pressure.
- The AIS Conduct Rules bar officers from public political commentary; the office speaks through files, not press statements.
- The steel-frame idea assumes permanence of the service against the impermanence of governments — continuity of the State above the party.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The 2024 Lok Sabha election was conducted with nearly 97 crore registered electors by lakhs of officers on election duty, drawn from every department and posted regardless of local political alignment.
- Central schemes are implemented by the same district machinery across states run by rival parties — non-partisanship is what makes federal delivery possible at all.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- T.N. Seshan's tenure as Chief Election Commissioner is cited abroad as a model of institutional independence.

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- The British convention of a permanent, politically neutral civil service that serves successive governments without turnover.

9 TOLERANCE

> Tolerance is not agreeing. It is not needing the other person to agree.

DEFINITION Accepting and respecting beliefs, practices and identities different from one's own without hostility — not indifference, and not mere endurance, but genuine acknowledgment of the other's right to be different.

KEYWORDS plurality · Article 25 · coexistence

QUOTES

- *"Anger and intolerance are the enemies of correct understanding." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2018)*
- *"Condemn none; if you can help, do so, else bless them and let them go their own way." — Swami Vivekananda (UPSC 2020)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A teacher who lets students of every faith observe their own practices in school without comment.
- A neighbour who attends a festival he does not believe in, because the friendship matters more than the theology.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Article 25 guarantees freedom of conscience and religion; the State's neutrality is what makes plural coexistence enforceable.
- District peace committees convened before festivals are an administrative technology of tolerance.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- During the 2018 Kerala floods a church sheltered idols from a flooded temple; after the July 2024 Wayanad landslides, mosques, churches and temples again opened as relief camps and community kitchens without asking survivors their faith.
- The harder contemporary test is online: tolerance now means declining to amplify content designed to make you hate a group.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- South Africa's Truth and Reconciliation Commission chose acknowledgment over revenge after apartheid.
- Canada's multiculturalism policy is the standard institutional model for accommodating diversity.

10 COURAGE AND FEARLESSNESS

> Courage is doing your duty with your hands shaking.

DEFINITION Doing one's duty without calculating the personal cost — holding to principle even when the consequences fall on oneself. Courage is not the absence of fear but action in its presence.

KEYWORDS fearlessness · principle over consequence · moral courage

QUOTES

- *"Courage is not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it." — Nelson Mandela*
- *"The world suffers because of the silence of good people." — Attributed to Napoleon Bonaparte*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

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- P.S. Appu, as Director of LBSNAA, pushed through reforms against heavy institutional resistance and later resigned rather than dilute them.
- A doctor who records the true cause of death in a case where powerful people would prefer a different entry.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The officers who exposed Bihar's fodder scam did so knowing the political backlash would land on their careers.
- Section 4 of the RTI Act obliges disclosure; using it against one's own department takes administrative courage.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Iranian women who continued protesting after Mahsa Amini's death in custody (September 2022), knowing the cost.
- Afghan girls who kept studying in secret schools after the Taliban barred them from secondary and university education.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Malala Yousafzai resumed her campaign for girls' education after surviving an assassination attempt.
- Aung San Suu Kyi endured long house arrest rather than abandon the demand for democracy in Myanmar.

11 FORTITUDE

> Courage lasts a moment. Fortitude has to last a year.

DEFINITION The mental strength to endure adversity, danger, pain or prolonged uncertainty with composure, and to remain committed to duty through it. Courage acts in a moment; fortitude lasts.

KEYWORDS endurance · composure · staying power

QUOTES

- *"If you want to test a man's character, give him power." — Abraham Lincoln (UPSC 2013)*
- *"Fortitude is the marshal of thought, the armour of the will." — Francis Bacon*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A cancer patient who continues working and supporting a family through treatment.
- A survivor who rebuilds a home and livelihood from nothing after a flood takes everything.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Soldiers holding the Siachen Glacier through extreme sub-zero conditions.
- District officials working eighteen-hour days for weeks through a disaster response, long after the news cameras leave.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Forty-one workers trapped in the Silkyara tunnel in Uttarakhand survived seventeen days underground (November 2023) with composure, while the rescue repeatedly failed and restarted.
- Vinesh Phogat was disqualified at Paris 2024 on the morning of her final for being 100 grams overweight; her conduct afterwards, and her decision to keep contesting the ruling on the record, is fortitude rather than mere disappointment.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Ukrainian civilians sustaining schools, hospitals and mutual aid through blackouts and bombardment.
- Survivors of the February 2023 Turkey–Syria earthquake rebuilding civic life from rubble.

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12 CONSCIENCE

> The voice that speaks when the rulebook has gone quiet.

DEFINITION The inner faculty that judges one's own conduct as right or wrong, independent of any external rule or sanction. It is the last check when law, orders and public opinion all fail.

KEYWORDS inner compass · no external rule · moral judgment

QUOTES

- *"Conscience is a man's compass." — Vincent van Gogh*
- *"Cowardice asks the question, is it safe? Conscience asks the question, is it right?" — Martin Luther King Jr.*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A juror who refuses to convict on weak evidence despite pressure to deliver a quick verdict.
- An official who returns a gift that was entirely legal to accept, because he knows why it was given.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Freedom fighters who chose conscience over colonial law and accepted jail rather than compromise on Swaraj.
- Journalists who kept reporting through Emergency censorship at real personal risk.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Doctors who kept working through the oxygen shortages of the second COVID-19 wave in April–May 2021, when there was no institutional protection and no good option.
- Employees who resign publicly rather than implement a decision they regard as wrong, forgoing severance and reference.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Conscientious objectors who refuse combat duty on moral or religious grounds and accept the penalty.
- Human-rights defenders who continue working under state repression because conscience gives them no exit.

13 CRISIS OF CONSCIENCE

> Not right versus wrong — that is temptation. This is every door costing you something.

DEFINITION The acute inner conflict when duty, orders or self-interest collide with one's own moral conviction, and no available option leaves the conscience clean.

KEYWORDS inner conflict · duty versus conviction

QUOTES

- *"Conscience does make cowards of us all." — William Shakespeare*
- *"The ultimate measure of a man is not where he stands in moments of comfort, but where he stands at times of challenge and controversy." — Martin Luther King Jr.*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A doctor asked to certify a false medical report, caught between a senior's instruction and professional ethics.
- An officer who must evict a settlement lawfully, knowing the families have nowhere to go that night.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Bureaucrats during the 1975–77 Emergency were caught between unlawful orders and their constitutional oath.

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- IAS officers Rajni Sekhri Sibbal and Poonam Malakondaiah both had to work through severe policy dilemmas in service.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Intensivists in April–May 2021 deciding which patient got the last oxygen bed — a choice in which every option cost a life.
- Officials asked to certify inflated scheme achievements to meet a target, knowing the number will later be used to deny people a benefit.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Officials at Nuremberg who later admitted they had never resolved the conflict between their orders and their conscience.
- Aid workers who must decide whether to accept a warring party's conditions or withdraw and leave civilians unassisted.

14 DEDICATION TO PUBLIC SERVICE

> The job is measured by what the citizen receives, not by what the rules require.

DEFINITION Giving one's time, energy and skill fully to public duty — doing more than the job description requires, because the job is measured by what citizens actually receive.

KEYWORDS beyond duty hours · service before self

QUOTES

- *"The service of India means the service of the poor." — Jawaharlal Nehru*
- *"The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2020)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Ajay Shankar Pandey, IAS, reaches office ten minutes early each day to clean his own cabin.
- A rural nurse who walks several kilometres daily to reach patients in villages with no road.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- ASHA workers' sustained fieldwork through the pandemic went far beyond formal duty hours; the WHO gave India's ASHA workforce a Global Health Leaders Award in 2022.
- Anganwadi workers who run nutrition, immunisation and pre-school work on modest honoraria.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The rat-hole miners at Silkyara (November 2023) volunteered to dig the final stretch by hand after the auger machine broke, then returned to obscurity.
- Retired doctors who returned to duty during COVID-19 waves, with no obligation to do so.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Doctors Without Borders volunteers who serve in conflict and epidemic zones far from home.
- Ronald Reagan left a successful acting career to enter public office.

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15 ALTRUISM

> Help that cannot be traced back to you.

DEFINITION Selfless concern for the well-being of others, expressed in voluntary acts of help that bring no reward and are not owed as duty. The purest form expects not even recognition.

KEYWORDS selflessness · voluntary · no reward

QUOTES

- *"The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2020)*
- *"We make a living by what we get, but we make a life by what we give." — Winston Churchill*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A commuter who buys food each morning for people sleeping on the street.
- A retired teacher running a free evening school for slum children out of her pension.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Anonymous donors who fund free eye-surgery camps in rural districts without a plaque or a photograph.
- Officers who quietly pay a poor patient's hospital bill from their own salary and never mention it.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Under Vaccine Maitri (2021) India supplied COVID-19 vaccines to other countries even while its own campaign was incomplete — though critics argue the calculation was partly strategic, which is exactly the line altruism must cross.
- Community kitchens and 'oxygen langars' run by ordinary citizens during the 2021 wave, funded by strangers for strangers.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Gates Foundation's funding of global vaccination programmes.
- MacKenzie Scott's large, unrestricted, no-strings donations to organisations she does not sit on the board of.

16 FORBEARANCE

> Strength that declines to use itself.

DEFINITION Patient self-restraint — deliberately withholding a reaction one is fully entitled to make, out of tolerance, magnanimity or strategic wisdom. It is strength declining to use itself.

KEYWORDS restraint · patience · strategic silence

QUOTES

- *"Patience is bitter, but its fruit is sweet." — Aristotle*
- *"An eye for an eye will only make the whole world blind." — Attributed to Mahatma Gandhi*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A senior who swallows a sharp reply to a junior's mistake and chooses to teach instead of humiliate.
- An officer who ignores a subordinate's public criticism of him and continues to mentor the man anyway.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The British decision not to arrest the peaceful Dandi marchers in 1930 was an act of forbearance that Gandhi himself acknowledged.

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- A District Magistrate who lets a protest run its course and negotiates, rather than ordering a lathi charge that would create martyrs.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- When a stray missile killed two people in Przewodów, Poland (November 2022), Poland and NATO deliberately investigated before responding rather than treating it as an Article 5 trigger — restraint that prevented a wider war.
- Police forces that have shifted to negotiated management of large protests instead of force, accepting short-term disorder to avoid long-term grievance.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Israel's calibrated, delayed responses to smaller provocations are analysed as strategic forbearance aimed at avoiding regional escalation.
- Nelson Mandela's refusal to pursue retribution against apartheid's enforcers after taking power.

17 TRUSTWORTHINESS AND PUBLIC TRUST

> Trust arrives on foot and leaves on horseback.

DEFINITION Being reliable enough that others place confidence in you. Public trust is society's collective faith in an office or institution — it is what allows the State to act boldly, and it is spent far faster than it is built.

KEYWORDS **credibility · institutional faith · compliance without coercion**

QUOTES

- *"Trust is the glue of life. It is the most essential ingredient in effective communication." — Stephen R. Covey*
- *"Trust arrives on foot and leaves on horseback." — Dutch proverb*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An Election Commissioner whose decisions are accepted without heavy enforcement, simply because of who is signing them.
- A doctor whose patients accept a difficult prognosis because they have never known him to shade the truth.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Aadhaar-linked Direct Benefit Transfer works only because beneficiaries trust that the money will actually arrive in the account.
- The credibility of the Election Commission, the CAG and the judiciary is a national asset that no budget line can replace.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- UPI crossed 10 billion transactions in a single month for the first time in August 2023 — a payments system that runs on public trust more than on enforcement.
- Trust is now the target of attack: deepfaked voices of officials and fake advisories are designed to spend down institutional credibility.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Volodymyr Zelenskyy's wartime credibility meant Ukrainians largely complied with martial law and mobilisation without coercion.
- The 2018 wallet-drop experiment across 40 countries found most wallets were returned with the cash intact.

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18 SPORTSMANSHIP

> Respect for the opponent survives the result.

DEFINITION Respect for the game, the rules and the opponent — playing fairly and accepting the result gracefully, even when fairness costs the win.

KEYWORDS fair play · grace in defeat · spirit of the game

QUOTES

- *"The most important thing is not to win but to take part." — Pierre de Coubertin*
- *"Winning is not everything, but wanting to win is." — Vince Lombardi*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- MS Dhoni recalled England batsman Ian Bell after a dismissal Dhoni felt was technically valid but unfair.
- Virat Kohli stopped Indian fans from booing Steve Smith and asked them to applaud him instead.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Anti-doping rules apply to the reigning champion and the debutant identically; a federation that shields its star destroys the sport it exists to protect.
- Officials who declare a result against their own home team when the evidence requires it.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- At Paris 2024, Arshad Nadeem of Pakistan won javelin gold and Neeraj Chopra took silver; the two men embraced, and both mothers publicly spoke of the other's son as their own — sportsmanship at the level of nations, not just athletes.
- Paris 2024 was the first Olympics with an equal number of male and female athlete quota places, which changes what the 'spirit of the game' is understood to include.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Andrew Flintoff consoling Brett Lee moments after Australia's narrow loss in the 2005 Ashes at Edgbaston — cricket's defining image of sportsmanship.
- Judoka who bow to an opponent who has just beaten them, before the result is announced.

19 DUTY VS OBLIGATION

> An obligation can be discharged. Only a duty can be exceeded.

DEFINITION An obligation is what a person must do because of law, contract or office, enforceable from outside. A duty is what a person chooses to do from an inner sense of what is right, with no external compulsion. Every obligation can be discharged; only duty can be exceeded.

KEYWORDS external compulsion vs inner sense · Article 51A

QUOTES

- *"Do your duty; leave the rest to time." — Mahatma Gandhi*
- *"You have a right to your duty, not to the fruits of action." — Bhagavad Gita*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A lifeguard on shift is obligated to attempt a rescue; a passer-by who cannot swim but runs for help acts purely from duty.

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- A citizen who pays tax is meeting an obligation; one who reports a leaking public pipeline is acting on duty.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- A soldier is obligated by military law to fight; volunteering for the hardest posting is duty.
- Fundamental Duties in Article 51A are constitutionally listed but not judicially enforceable — the Constitution itself marks the line between obligation and duty.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The rat-hole miners at Silkyara had no legal obligation to enter that tunnel; they went in because someone had to.
- Doctors and safai karamcharis during COVID-19 met their obligations by contract, but almost all of what they actually did lay beyond it.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Doctors are obligated by their oath to treat patients; those who fly unpaid into disaster zones act from duty alone.
- Good Samaritan laws in some countries convert what was only a duty into an obligation, precisely because duty alone proved unreliable.

ATTITUDE AND SOCIAL PSYCHOLOGY

How attitudes form, and how they are changed — the theory behind every behaviour-change answer.

20. Socialization And Its Agencies · 21. Conformity · 22. Obedience · 23. Persuasion · 24. Bureaucratic Vs Democratic Attitude · 25. Intuition · 26. Cooperation

20 SOCIALIZATION AND ITS AGENCIES

> Nobody is taught ethics. Everybody absorbs them.

DEFINITION The lifelong process by which a person absorbs the values, norms and culture of society. Its agencies are family, school, peer group, workplace, religion, media and, increasingly, the algorithmic feed.

KEYWORDS **family, school, peers, media · the algorithmic feed**

QUOTES

- *"Whoever I am today, and whatever I will be tomorrow, I owe to my angel mother." — Abraham Lincoln*
- *"Give me a child until he is seven and I will show you the man." — Attributed to Aristotle*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A child who becomes honest after watching a parent return extra change at a shop, without a word being said about honesty.
- A teenager who starts queueing patiently because that is simply what his friends do.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- NCERT's value-education modules use schooling deliberately as an agency of ethical socialization.
- Foundation courses at LBSNAA are designed to socialise entrants into service values before their first posting.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Social media is now a primary agency of socialization and the least supervised one: Australia legislated a minimum age of 16 for social-media accounts (passed November 2024), an explicit attempt to regulate who is

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doing the socialising.

- NEP 2020 and the 2023 National Curriculum Framework put values and ethics back into the formal curriculum rather than leaving them to the family alone.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Scandinavian gender-neutral upbringing in family and school is a deliberate socialization policy.
- Finland's investment in early-childhood education treats the first years as the decisive socializing window.

21 CONFORMITY

> People will deny what their own eyes see rather than stand alone.

DEFINITION Changing one's attitude or behaviour to match a group — either to be accepted (normative influence) or because one assumes the group knows better (informational influence). Asch's line experiments showed people will deny plain evidence to avoid standing alone.

KEYWORDS normative vs informational · Asch · peer pressure

QUOTES

- *"Whenever you find yourself on the side of the majority, it is time to pause and reflect." — Mark Twain*
- *"It is better to be alone than in bad company." — George Washington*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A new employee who starts arriving late because that is the unspoken norm of the team.
- An officer who signs off on a flawed proposal because every colleague already has.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Traffic discipline improves in a city largely because most drivers are visibly following the rule — conformity working for the State.
- Swachh Bharat worked partly by making cleanliness a visible norm, so littering became socially awkward rather than merely illegal.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Online pile-ons and cancellation dynamics are textbook normative conformity: most participants have no independent view of the case.
- Retail investor herding in meme-stock and crypto episodes is informational conformity — buying because others are buying, not because of any valuation.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Vaccine hesitancy spreading through a community follows informational conformity to local opinion leaders more than to data.
- The bystander effect in public emergencies, where each person's inaction confirms everyone else's.

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22 OBEDIENCE

> Evil rarely needs villains. It needs people who file the paperwork.

DEFINITION Compliance with the direct order of an authority figure, even against one's own moral judgment. Milgram showed that most ordinary people will inflict harm if responsibility is visibly shifted onto the authority.

KEYWORDS Milgram · authority · shifted responsibility

QUOTES

- *"Obedience is the psychological mechanism that links individual action to political purpose." — Stanley Milgram*
- *"I was only following orders." — the Nuremberg defence, rejected by the Tribunal*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A junior officer who carries out a clearly unjust order and later says he was only following instructions.
- A soldier who obeys a lawful chain-of-command order during a rescue despite personal danger — obedience is not always destructive.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Jallianwala Bagh massacre is the standard Indian case of destructive obedience to General Dyer's order.
- Indian service rules require an officer to obey lawful orders, and to record dissent in the file rather than comply silently with an unlawful one.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Corporate fraud cases from Volkswagen's emissions software to Wirecard have turned on employees who followed instructions they knew were wrong, precisely because the instruction came from above.
- Documented atrocities in the Ukraine war have again raised the question of when a soldier's duty is to refuse.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Holocaust remains the starkest case of mass destructive obedience.
- The Nuremberg Trials established that an unlawful order is not a defence, which is now settled international law.

23 PERSUASION

> Changing a mind is cheaper than changing a law.

DEFINITION Changing another's attitude through communication rather than coercion. Aristotle's three appeals still hold: ethos (the speaker's credibility), logos (argument and evidence) and pathos (emotion).

KEYWORDS ethos, logos, pathos · nudge · behaviour change

QUOTES

- *"If you would win a man to your cause, first convince him that you are his sincere friend." — Abraham Lincoln*
- *"The right word may be effective, but no word was ever as effective as a rightly timed pause." — Mark Twain*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A doctor who persuades a hesitant patient to vaccinate by citing both her own experience and the data.
- A field officer who convinces farmers to adopt drip irrigation by showing them a neighbour's yield figures, not a circular.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Swachh Bharat used the Prime Minister and public figures as referent-power appeals rather than relying on fines.

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- The Economic Survey 2018-19 devoted a chapter to behavioural economics — using nudges rather than penalties to shift public behaviour.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- India crossed 200 crore COVID-19 vaccine doses by July 2022; that was an exercise in mass persuasion — local influencers, religious leaders and ASHA workers doing the convincing that no mandate could have achieved.
- The same tools now work in reverse: anti-vaccine and communal content spread through exactly the ethos-pathos combination that public health campaigns rely on.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Anti-smoking campaigns pair graphic warnings (pathos) with mortality statistics (logos).
- The UK's Behavioural Insights Team redesigned letters and forms so that compliance rose without any change in the law.

24 BUREAUCRATIC VS DEMOCRATIC ATTITUDE

> Rule-bound in the emergency. Participative in the plan.

DEFINITION A bureaucratic attitude applies rigid, top-down rules and delivers speed and uniformity. A democratic attitude is flexible and participative, and delivers legitimacy at the cost of time. Good administration is knowing which one the situation demands.

KEYWORDS **speed vs legitimacy · rigid vs flexible**

QUOTES

- *"Rules are not necessarily sacred, principles are." — Franklin D. Roosevelt*
- *"A government of laws, and not of men." — John Adams*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A supervisor who enforces safety rules strictly on paper but listens to the ground staff on how to meet them.
- An officer who follows the disaster protocol to the letter during the emergency and holds open consultations during reconstruction.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Emergency response runs on rule-bound NDMA protocol; local development planning runs on participation.
- The Election Commission is rigidly rule-bound on polling-day procedure and consultative when framing new voter-facing reforms.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Aspirational Districts and Aspirational Blocks Programme (blocks added in January 2023) combine the two: centrally fixed indicators and rankings, with district-level freedom on how to move them.
- Kerala's People's Plan Campaign remains the strongest Indian example of participative local governance producing better, not merely more popular, decisions.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- New Zealand's New Public Management reforms pushed bureaucracies toward citizen-participative service design.
- Estonia's e-government keeps procedure rigid and the citizen interface flexible.

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25 INTUITION

> Intuition is recognition — and only as good as the experience behind it.

DEFINITION Judgment that arrives without conscious step-by-step reasoning — the 'gut feeling' of an expert. It is compressed experience, and it is only as reliable as the experience behind it.

KEYWORDS gut feeling · compressed experience · Simon, Kahneman

QUOTES

- *"The intuitive mind is a sacred gift and the rational mind is a faithful servant." — Albert Einstein*
- *"Intuition is nothing more and nothing less than recognition." — Herbert Simon*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An experienced doctor who senses something is wrong with a patient before any test confirms it.
- A District Magistrate who senses tension building in a locality and moves preventively, before anything has formally happened.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Gandhi's decision to call off the Non-Cooperation Movement after Chauri Chaura (1922) is read as an intuitive course-correction against the advice of his own colleagues.
- His launch of Quit India in 1942, sensing the public mood despite the certainty of reprisal, was the same instinct proved right.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Intuition is now in direct competition with the algorithm: when a diagnostic model and an experienced clinician disagree, someone has to decide which to override — and the ethics of that choice is unsettled.
- Disaster managers routinely order an evacuation on a judgment call before the model justifies it; the cost of being wrong is low, the cost of waiting is not.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Stanislav Petrov's 1983 judgment that a Soviet early-warning alert was a false alarm — he was right, and reported it as a malfunction rather than an attack.
- Kahneman's work on when expert intuition is trustworthy: only in environments regular enough to have taught the expert anything.

26 COOPERATION

> Most administrative failure is coordination failure wearing a technical mask.

DEFINITION Individuals or agencies working towards a shared benefit instead of competing for a purely private one. In administration, most failure is not a failure of capability but of coordination.

KEYWORDS shared benefit · unified command · convergence

QUOTES

- *"Alone we can do so little; together we can do so much." — Helen Keller*
- *"If you want to go fast, go alone. If you want to go far, go together." — African proverb*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Ravish Kumar's Magsaysay acceptance speech credited over fifty people who had taught him along the way.

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- A team leader who shares credit for a scheme's success with the block-level staff who actually delivered it.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The 2018 Meghalaya rat-hole mining tragedy, in which fifteen trapped miners died, was worsened by poor coordination between rescue agencies and a shortage of adequate pumps — a cooperation failure, not a technology failure.
- Disaster response now runs on a unified command precisely because agencies working in parallel had proved worse than agencies working under one.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Silkyara tunnel rescue (November 2023) succeeded because NDRF, SDRF, ONGC, RVNL, the Army, an Australian tunnelling expert and a dozen rat-hole miners all worked one problem — and the final metres were dug by hand after the imported auger machine failed.
- The G20 New Delhi Declaration (September 2023) was agreed by consensus in a badly divided room, and the African Union was admitted as a permanent member.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Global crowdfunding financed a private search for footballer Emiliano Sala's lost aircraft in 2019 after the official search was called off.
- COVAX pooled procurement so that poorer countries had some access to vaccines, though the outcome fell well short of the design.

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

Goleman's components, plus the emotional failures — prejudice, dissonance, hatred — that they guard against.

27. Emotional Intelligence · 28. Self-Awareness · 29. Self-Regulation · 30. Empathy · 31. Compassion · 32. Prejudice · 33. Cognitive Dissonance · 34. Ethical Dilemma · 35. Hatred And Intolerance

27 EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

> IQ gets you the post. EQ gets you the cooperation.

DEFINITION The ability to recognise, understand and manage one's own emotions and those of others, and to use that awareness to communicate, build relationships and resolve conflict. Goleman's five components: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy and social skill.

KEYWORDS **Goleman · five components · EQ over IQ**

QUOTES

- *"The success of any organisation depends 80 per cent on EQ and 20 per cent on IQ." — Daniel Goleman*
- *"No one cares how much you know, until they know how much you care." — Theodore Roosevelt*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- S. Somvanshi, IAS, gave up the air-conditioner in his own office so it could cool a centre for malnourished children.
- A team leader who steadies an anxious colleague before a high-stakes meeting instead of adding to the pressure.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- N. Prashant, as Collector of Kozhikode, settled a street-market relocation dispute through persuasion and relationship-building rather than force.

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- Grievance redressal is an emotional-intelligence task before it is a procedural one: most complainants want to be heard before they want to be right.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- During the 2020 lockdown, the officers who handled the migrant-worker crisis best were those who arranged food, transport and information first and enforcement second.
- Public communication in a crisis now runs on EI: officials who acknowledged shortages honestly during the 2021 oxygen crisis retained credibility; those who denied them lost it permanently.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Jacinda Ardern's response to the 2019 Christchurch attack — presence, plain language and visible grief — is the standard modern case study.
- UN mediators use emotional intelligence to de-escalate hostility long before any text is negotiated.

28 SELF-AWARENESS

> You are the easiest person you will ever fool.

DEFINITION Goleman's first component — accurately knowing one's own emotions, strengths, limits and motives, and understanding their effect on others. Without it, no other component of EI can be trusted.

KEYWORDS **blind spots · first component · 360-degree feedback**

QUOTES

- *"Knowing yourself is the beginning of all wisdom." — Aristotle*
- *"The first principle is that you must not fool yourself, and you are the easiest person to fool." — Richard Feynman*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A civil servant who recognises his own impatience and consciously slows down during public grievance hearings.
- An officer who declines a portfolio he knows he is temperamentally wrong for, instead of taking it for the prestige.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- LBSNAA's Foundation Course includes self-assessment modules deliberately placed before the first field posting.
- Mission Karmayogi's competency framework assesses behavioural attributes, not just domain knowledge — an institutional bet on self-awareness.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- 360-degree feedback has moved from private-sector HR into public administration; the discomfort it causes is the point.
- Public figures who acknowledge the limits of their own expertise on live television now stand out precisely because so few do.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Executive coaching in Singapore's civil-service academy is designed to surface senior officials' blind spots.
- 360-degree feedback tools are standard across OECD civil services for leadership development.

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29 SELF-REGULATION

> Between stimulus and response lies your entire reputation.

DEFINITION Goleman's second component — controlling disruptive impulses and adapting calmly to change instead of reacting in the moment. It is the gap between stimulus and response, deliberately held open.

KEYWORDS impulse control · Frankl's space · adaptability

QUOTES

- *"He who reigns within himself and rules his passions is more than a king." — John Milton*
- *"Between stimulus and response there is a space; in that space is our power to choose." — Viktor Frankl*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An officer who pauses before answering an abusive citizen at a grievance camp instead of matching his tone.
- A supervisor who reads an insulting email twice and replies the next morning.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Traffic police trained to stay composed under provocation during VIP movement and protest duty.
- Airport and railway staff trained to remain courteous when passengers turn abusive during delays.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Officials now face sustained personal abuse online; the professional norm is not to answer in kind, which is self-regulation practised in public and at scale.
- The AIS Conduct Rules restrict officers' social-media conduct precisely because the medium rewards the unregulated response.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Diplomats trained to stay measured through hostile press conferences during bilateral crises.
- Central bankers who decline to answer political provocation and speak only to the data.

30 EMPATHY

> Sympathy feels for. Empathy feels with.

DEFINITION Goleman's fourth component — understanding another person's feelings from their point of view, not merely noticing their distress. Sympathy feels for; empathy feels with.

KEYWORDS perspective-taking · fourth component

QUOTES

- *"Empathy is seeing with the eyes of another, listening with the ears of another, and feeling with the heart of another." — Alfred Adler*
- *"You never really understand a person until you consider things from his point of view." — Harper Lee*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A doctor who takes the extra ten minutes to explain a diagnosis gently to a frightened patient.
- An officer who conducts a hearing in the applicant's language rather than making him struggle in English.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Officials during the 2018 Kerala floods went beyond protocol to trace and reunite displaced families.

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- Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan redesigns public buildings and transport around how a disabled citizen actually experiences them, which is empathy translated into engineering.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- After the July 2024 Wayanad landslides, the administration's handling of unidentified bodies — DNA matching, dignified burial, and communication with families — was an act of empathy that no protocol required.
- Empathy is the missing input in digital governance: a portal designed by someone who has never had a failed OTP will exclude the people who need it most.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Red Cross workers in conflict zones who address civilians' trauma alongside their physical injuries.
- UNICEF's child-friendly spaces in refugee camps are built around a child's emotional needs, not just physical safety.

31 COMPASSION

> Empathy that stays in the chair is only a feeling.

DEFINITION Empathy that acts. It notices suffering, is moved by it, and then does something to relieve it. Compassion without action is sentiment; action without feeling is administration.

KEYWORDS **kindness that acts · relief of suffering**

QUOTES

- *"Love and compassion are necessities, not luxuries. Without them humanity cannot survive." — Dalai Lama*
- *"The simplest acts of kindness are by far more powerful than a thousand heads bowing in prayer." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2022)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Swati Bhadauria, as District Magistrate, admitted her own son to an anganwadi rather than a private school — and the anganwadi improved.
- Avnish Sharan, IAS, walked his daughter into her first class at a government school.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Rahul Kumar, as DM of Gopalganj, was known for district leadership that began from the citizen's distress rather than the file's requirement.
- PM Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana provides free foodgrains to roughly 80 crore people, extended for five years from January 2024 — compassion converted into an entitlement.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The state response to the 2024 Wayanad landslides included rebuilding and rehabilitation packages, not merely relief and a photograph.
- Compassion at scale is the harder test: a scheme that reaches 80 crore people cannot be run on feeling, but it collapses without it.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Angela Merkel's 2015 decision to open Germany's borders to Syrian refugees, at heavy political cost to herself.
- Volunteer networks in Poland who housed millions of Ukrainian refugees in private homes within weeks in 2022.

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32 PREJUDICE

> An opinion formed before the evidence arrives — and defended after it does.

DEFINITION A negative attitude towards a person or group formed in advance of, or in defiance of, evidence. It is an attitude; discrimination is that attitude in action. Stereotype is its cognitive component.

KEYWORDS stereotype · pre-judgment · attitude vs discrimination

QUOTES

- *"Prejudice is what fools use for reason." — Voltaire*
- *"No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin, or his background, or his religion." — Nelson Mandela*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An interviewer who unconsciously rates a candidate lower after hearing his surname or his district.
- A landlord who refuses a flat to a tenant on the basis of diet or marital status.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Caste prejudice once barred entry to public wells and temples; Article 17 abolished untouchability, but the attitude outlived the law.
- Sensitisation training for police on how first-response behaviour changes with the complainant's caste, gender or language.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Algorithmic bias has industrialised prejudice: Amazon scrapped an AI recruiting tool that had taught itself to downgrade women's résumés, and facial-recognition systems have been shown to perform worst on darker-skinned women.
- Seattle became the first US city to ban caste discrimination (February 2023), acknowledging that prejudice migrates with people.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Mid-twentieth-century US 'redlining' encoded racial prejudice into mortgage maps.
- The Rohingya in Myanmar were dehumanised in public discourse long before they were expelled.

33 COGNITIVE DISSONANCE

> We do not change the behaviour. We change the story.

DEFINITION Festinger's term for the discomfort of holding two contradictory beliefs, or of acting against one's own stated values. It is usually resolved not by changing the behaviour but by rationalising it away — which is why it matters for ethics.

KEYWORDS Festinger · rationalisation · belief vs action

QUOTES

- *"A man convinced against his will is of the same opinion still." — Benjamin Franklin*
- *"It is difficult to get a man to understand something when his salary depends on his not understanding it." — Upton Sinclair*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

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- A smoker who knows the risk perfectly and re-describes the habit as a temporary stress-reliever.
- A citizen who demands strict anti-corruption law and pays a bribe to move his own file faster.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Officials who publicly champion environmental norms while quietly clearing projects that breach them.
- Departments that celebrate a scheme's coverage figures while knowing the last-mile data is inflated.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- COP28 in Dubai (2023) produced the first explicit global call to transition away from fossil fuels — hosted by a major oil producer whose COP president also headed the national oil company. The dissonance was the story.
- Consumers report high concern about climate change and simultaneously drive the growth of fast fashion and same-day delivery.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Governments that champion human rights abroad while continuing arms sales to regimes accused of abusing them.
- Countries that pledge net zero while approving new coal and oil licences.

34 ETHICAL DILEMMA

> Right versus wrong is temptation. Right versus right is a dilemma.

DEFINITION A situation in which every available option requires sacrificing a genuine moral value. A dilemma is not right versus wrong — that is merely temptation. It is right versus right.

KEYWORDS **competing values · no clean option**

QUOTES

- *"The test of a first-rate intelligence is the ability to hold two opposed ideas in mind at the same time and still retain the ability to function." — F. Scott Fitzgerald*
- *"Where there is no struggle, there is no strength." — Oprah Winfrey*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A doctor with one ventilator and two equally critical patients.
- An officer asked by a senior to overlook a small violation by a locally powerful figure, where enforcing the rule will end her posting and not end the violation.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Deciding who receives a scarce vaccine first — the old, the frontline worker, or the economically essential.
- Evicting an encroachment that is legally indefensible and is also the only home the family has.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Development versus ecology in real cases: large infrastructure and mining proposals in ecologically fragile zones pit livelihoods and national capability against irreversible loss.
- Autonomous vehicles force the trolley problem into code: someone must write down, in advance, whom the car will hit.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Humanitarian access in war: accepting a warring party's conditions to feed civilians can also legitimise that party.
- Nations weighing economic growth against their share of global climate responsibility.

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35 HATRED AND INTOLERANCE

> Hatred is never spontaneous. It is manufactured — and it is always cheap.

DEFINITION An extreme aversion that distorts judgment and can trap whole communities in cycles of resentment and violence. Hatred is rarely spontaneous — it is manufactured, and it is always cheaper to spread than to undo.

KEYWORDS dehumanisation · rumour · cycle of revenge

QUOTES

- *"Hatred is never appeased by hatred; hatred is appeased by love alone." — Gautama Buddha (Dhammapada)*
- *"I have decided to stick with love; hate is too great a burden to bear." — Martin Luther King Jr.*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A person who mutes and reports the accounts that exist to provoke communal anger, rather than arguing with them.
- A neighbour who publicly refuses to repeat a rumour about another community.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Communal riots are almost always preceded by rumour; district peace committees exist to break that chain before it becomes violence.
- Hate-speech provisions under the IPC, now the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, criminalise incitement to enmity between groups.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The 2023 Manipur violence showed how quickly an inter-community grievance, amplified by rumour and an internet shutdown that cut both facts and falsehoods, can become mass displacement.
- The Israel–Gaza war since October 2023 has been accompanied by a sharp global rise in both antisemitic and Islamophobic incidents, in countries thousands of kilometres from the conflict.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Rwandan genocide is studied worldwide as the endpoint of unchecked, broadcast ethnic hatred.
- A UN fact-finding mission concluded that social media had played a determining role in the incitement against the Rohingya in Myanmar.

GOVERNANCE

The institutional layer. Values become checkable only when a law, an audit or an office enforces them.

36. Transparency · 37. Accountability · 38. Whistleblowing · 39. Corruption · 40. Nepotism · 41. Public Interest · 42. Rule Of Law · 43. Social Justice · 44. Good Governance · 45. Ethical Governance · 46. Constitutional Morality · 47. Citizen'S Charter · 48. Right To Information · 49. Code Of Ethics Vs Code Of Conduct · 50. Conflict Of Interest

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36 TRANSPARENCY

> Without transparency, accountability is voluntary.

DEFINITION Openness of decision-making — citizens can see accurate, timely information about what the government is doing and why. Transparency is the precondition of accountability; without it, answerability is voluntary.

KEYWORDS openness · suo motu disclosure · sunlight

QUOTES

- *"Sunlight is said to be the best of disinfectants; electric light the most efficient policeman." — Louis Brandeis*
- *"Information is the currency of democracy." — Attributed to Thomas Jefferson*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A clerk who posts the status of pending applications on the notice board without being asked.
- A ration-shop dealer who displays daily stock and prices where every buyer can see them.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- GeM took government procurement online and cut the discretion that made collusion possible; its transaction value crossed Rs 4 lakh crore in 2023-24.
- Section 4 of the RTI Act requires suo motu disclosure — the department must publish before the citizen asks.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Supreme Court struck down electoral bonds in February 2024, holding that voters' right to know outweighed donor anonymity, and required the SBI to disclose the data.
- DBT and scheme dashboards publish beneficiary and expenditure data in near real time, which changes what can be quietly buried.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative requires member countries to publish oil, gas and mining revenues.
- Estonia lets citizens see which official accessed their personal data, and when.

37 ACCOUNTABILITY

> Answerability without consequence is theatre.

DEFINITION The obligation to answer for one's decisions to the public and to oversight bodies, and to bear consequences. Answerability without consequence is theatre; accountability requires both.

KEYWORDS answerability + consequence · oversight

QUOTES

- *"Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely." — Lord Acton*
- *"The buck stops here." — Harry S. Truman*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A municipal engineer held personally liable for a bridge collapse traced to substandard material he certified.
- An officer who reports his own error to his superior before it is discovered.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

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- The Public Accounts Committee examines the CAG's findings and requires ministries to explain irregularities.
- State Information Commissions can penalise officials who fail to answer RTI applications within the statutory period.
- Lal Bahadur Shastri's resignation after a rail accident set a standard of moral accountability that survives precisely because it is so rarely followed.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Balasore triple train crash (June 2023) killed close to 300 people and was traced to a signalling-circuit failure; the debate that followed — systemic versus individual versus ministerial responsibility — is the accountability question in its modern form.
- The Morbi bridge collapse (October 2022) killed 135 people after a private operator reopened a repaired bridge without a fitness certificate; the courts have had to supervise the accountability process.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The International Criminal Court issued an arrest warrant for a sitting head of state in March 2023 over the unlawful deportation of children.
- Ministerial resignations in Westminster systems for departmental failure the minister did not personally cause.

38 WHISTLEBLOWING

> The system's immune response usually targets the whistle-blower, not the disease.

DEFINITION Disclosing wrongdoing inside an organisation to authorities or to the public, usually at serious personal cost. The whistle-blower's dilemma is loyalty to the institution against loyalty to the public it serves.

KEYWORDS **disclosure at personal cost · loyalty conflict**

QUOTES

- *"The public has a right to know what its government is doing in its name." — Daniel Ellsberg*
- *"Silence in the face of injustice is complicity with the oppressor." — Attributed to Desmond Tutu*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Satyendra Dubey exposed corruption in the Golden Quadrilateral project and was murdered in 2003.
- Dr. Kafeel Khan raised the alarm over a hospital oxygen shortage in Gorakhpur in 2017, was blamed and jailed, and was later cleared.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Whistle Blowers Protection Act, 2014 was passed but its rules were never notified, so the protection it promises is still not operational — a gap the 2nd ARC had warned about.
- Internal vigilance mechanisms allow disclosure inside the system; whistleblowing usually begins where they have already failed.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Frances Haugen's disclosure of internal Facebook research (2021) showed that the company's own studies had found harms it publicly denied.
- Dozens of RTI users have been attacked or killed since 2005 — in practice, the RTI applicant is India's most exposed whistle-blower, and the least protected.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Edward Snowden's 2013 disclosure of NSA mass surveillance forced a global debate on privacy versus security, and left him in exile.

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- Chelsea Manning leaked classified US military files to WikiLeaks in 2010, citing a duty to expose wrongdoing.

39 CORRUPTION

> The certificate existed. The inspection did not.

DEFINITION The abuse of entrusted power for private gain (World Bank). It ranges from petty bribery at the counter to grand corruption in policy and resource allocation, and its deepest cost is not the money but the loss of faith.

KEYWORDS abuse of entrusted power · private gain · petty vs grand

QUOTES

- *"Corruption is a cancer that eats away at a citizen's faith in democracy." — Joe Biden*
- *"Three people can bring change and make a nation corruption-free — the father, the mother and the teacher." — Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (UPSC 2017)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A clerk who demands money to issue a routine caste certificate to a poor applicant.
- The ICICI Bank case, in which the CEO resigned after a conflict-of-interest and quid-pro-quo loan scandal came to light.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The 2G spectrum and coal-block allocations exposed how discretion in resource allocation becomes grand corruption.
- The Karol Bagh hotel fire (2019) killed 17 people in a building that held a fire-safety clearance on paper — paperwork corruption kills.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Morbi bridge collapse (2022) is the same lesson repeated: the certificate existed, the inspection did not.
- The collapse of the crypto exchange FTX (November 2022) and its founder's fraud conviction showed that grand corruption no longer needs a government office to operate from.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Malaysia's 1MDB scandal ended with a former prime minister imprisoned.
- Transparency International's Corruption Perceptions Index tracks how corrupt the public sector is perceived to be across nearly 180 countries.

40 NEPOTISM

> Merit is what you lose when the shortlist is a family tree.

DEFINITION Favouring relatives or close associates in appointment, promotion or contract, bypassing merit. Cronyism is its wider form: favouring friends and allies rather than kin.

KEYWORDS kinship over merit · cronyism · dynasty

QUOTES

- *"Nothing is politically right which is morally wrong." — Daniel O'Connell*
- *"When the character of a man is not clear to you, look at his friends." — Confucius*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

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- A department head who hires his nephew over better-qualified candidates.
- A manager who denies a deserving outsider a promotion in order to place a personal friend.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Recruitment through the UPSC and staff selection commissions exists precisely to take appointment out of personal hands.
- Rules requiring recusal where a relative is a candidate, and disclosure of relatives employed in the same department.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Dynastic candidate selection is debated across almost every major political party in India — the criticism is bipartisan because the practice is.
- In start-ups and family firms, nepotism now takes the form of cap-table appointments: board seats decided by kinship rather than competence, until the funding round fails.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Bush and Clinton families in the United States have repeatedly drawn nepotism criticism within a functioning democracy.
- Family succession in monarchic and authoritarian systems is nepotism formalised as a constitution.

41 PUBLIC INTEREST

> Everyone claims it, so it must be argued — never merely asserted.

DEFINITION The collective welfare of the community, which must prevail over private or sectional advantage in policymaking. Its difficulty is that everyone claims it, so it must be argued for, not asserted.

KEYWORDS collective good · PIL · sectional interest

QUOTES

- *"The good of the people is the greatest law." — Cicero*
- *"The interest of the individual must be subordinate to the interest of the community." — Attributed to Cicero*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A regulator who blocks a hazardous drug despite pressure from a manufacturer with a strong lobby.
- A junior doctor who reports a colleague's malpractice knowing it will cost him professionally.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Right to Education Act placed universal schooling ahead of the economics of private schooling.
- Public Interest Litigation lets a citizen with no personal injury move the court on behalf of those who cannot.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- During COVID-19, India and South Africa proposed a TRIPS waiver at the WTO (2020) so that vaccine patents would not block supply; a limited waiver was agreed in 2022 — public interest asserted against intellectual property.
- The Supreme Court's suo motu intervention in oxygen allocation in 2021 treated distribution as a public-interest question, not a state-by-state negotiation.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Compulsory licensing of medicines during health emergencies overrides patents for public benefit.
- Public-health mandates on tobacco packaging upheld against trade and property claims.

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42 RULE OF LAW

> Punishment without trial is not open to the executive.

DEFINITION Dicey's principle that everyone — including the government — is equally bound by publicly known law, applied by independent courts, and that no one may be punished except for a proven breach of it.

KEYWORDS Dicey · equality before law · due process

QUOTES

- *"Be you never so high, the law is above you." — Lord Denning*
- *"Where law ends, tyranny begins." — William Pitt*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A traffic constable who fines a minister's car for a signal violation exactly as he would any other.
- An officer who insists on a written order before acting on a verbal instruction from above.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Courts routinely strike down executive orders that exceed constitutional limits.
- Three new criminal laws — the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita and the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam — came into force on 1 July 2024, replacing the colonial codes.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- In November 2024 the Supreme Court laid down nationwide guidelines against demolition of property without prior notice and hearing, holding that punishment without trial is not open to the executive — the rule of law asserted against a popular shortcut.
- Bail jurisprudence and the pace of undertrial detention remain the sharpest domestic test of whether the rule of law is real for the poor.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Pakistan's Supreme Court acquitted Asia Bibi in 2018, striking down a blasphemy conviction against overwhelming public pressure.
- The International Court of Justice hears cases against powerful states on the same standards it applies to weak ones.

43 SOCIAL JUSTICE

> Judge the institution by how it treats the last person, not the average one.

DEFINITION A fair distribution of resources, opportunity and dignity that actively corrects historical disadvantage. Rawls: institutions should be judged by how they treat the worst-off, not the average.

KEYWORDS Rawls · corrective equality · the worst-off

QUOTES

- *"Justice is the first virtue of social institutions, as truth is of systems of thought." — John Rawls*
- *"Rights are not real unless the conditions to exercise them exist." — Dr. B.R. Ambedkar (paraphrased from his writings on social democracy)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A teacher who gives free extra coaching to first-generation learners to close the gap they did not create.

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- A landlord who lowers rent for a tenant who lost a job during a crisis.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Reservation under the Constitution aims at correcting the disadvantage of historically excluded groups.
- The Supreme Court upheld EWS reservation in 2022, and in August 2024 a seven-judge bench permitted states to sub-classify Scheduled Castes so that benefits reach the most backward within the group.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam (106th Amendment, 2023) reserves one-third of Lok Sabha and Assembly seats for women, to take effect after a census and delimitation.
- PM-JANMAN (November 2023) targets Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups — the groups that every previous scheme reached last.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The US Supreme Court ended race-conscious college admissions in 2023, which reopened globally the question of whether corrective preference is itself unjust.
- South Africa's post-apartheid black economic empowerment framework remains the most ambitious attempt at legislated redress.

44 GOOD GOVERNANCE

> Good governance asks only whether the machine runs.

DEFINITION Governance that is participatory, transparent, accountable, responsive, equitable and effective — the UN's eight attributes. Its focus is administrative efficiency and citizen-centricity.

KEYWORDS **participation, transparency, accountability · efficiency**

QUOTES

- *"Good governance is perhaps the single most important factor in eradicating poverty and promoting development." — Kofi Annan*
- *"Minimum government, maximum governance." — a stated goal of Indian administrative reform*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A ward councillor who holds a monthly open forum and publishes what was fixed and what was not.
- A block officer who digitises land records so the farmer no longer needs a middleman to see his own entry.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Digital India, DigiLocker and UMANG shift service delivery from the counter to the phone, removing the discretion of the counter.
- The government estimates that Aadhaar-linked DBT has saved several lakh crore rupees by removing duplicate and ghost beneficiaries — the exact figure is contested, but the direction is not.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Aspirational Districts Programme, extended to blocks in 2023, ranks the worst-performing units on real-time indicators and publishes the ranking — competition as a governance tool.
- CPGRAMS now publishes grievance-disposal timelines and ministry-wise rankings, turning responsiveness into a measurable number.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The World Bank's Worldwide Governance Indicators rank countries on rule of law and government effectiveness.

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- Estonia's e-residency and digital state make almost every public service available online, permanently.

45 ETHICAL GOVERNANCE

> An efficient unjust decision is still unjust.

DEFINITION Governance that keeps ethical questions at the centre rather than treating them as a constraint — a step beyond good governance, which asks only whether the machine runs efficiently. An efficient unjust decision is still unjust.

KEYWORDS values before efficiency · means matter

QUOTES

- *"Ethics thrives on freedom, and freedom is the very essence of our humanity." — Kofi Annan*
- *"Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have a right to do and what is right to do." — Potter Stewart (UPSC 2022)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An officer who insists on full due process in a resettlement even though an unfair shortcut would close the file faster.
- A junior engineer who flags substandard material despite being told the deadline matters more.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Kerala's People's Plan Campaign is cited for embedding ethical, not merely efficient, local governance.
- A scheme that hits its target by excluding the hardest-to-reach beneficiaries is efficient and unethical at the same time.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Mission LiFE (2022) frames climate action as an ethical obligation of the individual citizen, not only a regulatory duty of the state.
- The EU AI Act, in force from August 2024, is the first serious attempt to make ethical constraints on technology legally binding rather than voluntary.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- New Zealand's Wellbeing Budget requires spending to be justified against citizen wellbeing, not only fiscal indicators.
- Bhutan's Gross National Happiness framework subordinates growth to a broader account of what the growth is for.

46 CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY

> The Constitution's morality — not the majority's.

DEFINITION Fidelity to the Constitution's core values — liberty, equality, fraternity and dignity — even when they conflict with prevailing social opinion. Ambedkar's warning was that it is not a natural sentiment: it has to be cultivated.

KEYWORDS Ambedkar · liberty, equality, fraternity · over social morality

QUOTES

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- *"Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment. It has to be cultivated. We must realise that our people have yet to learn it." — Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*
- *"The Constitution is not a mere lawyers' document; it is a vehicle of life, and its spirit is always the spirit of the age." — Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An official who enforces a court order protecting a minority's rights despite social backlash in his own locality.
- A citizen who defends the right of a group he dislikes to hold a lawful meeting.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Navtej Singh Johar (2018) decriminalised homosexuality by placing constitutional morality above social morality.
- Joseph Shine (2018) struck down adultery as a crime on the same reasoning — that the Constitution's view of the individual overrides the community's.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- In Supriyo v. Union of India (October 2023), the Supreme Court declined to read marriage equality into the law and left it to Parliament, while acknowledging the discrimination — a live illustration of where constitutional morality is contested rather than settled.
- Debates over the Uniform Civil Code turn precisely on whether constitutional morality can override community practice, and who decides.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- US civil-rights-era rulings enforced school desegregation against determined majoritarian resistance.
- The German Basic Law's 'eternity clause' places human dignity beyond the reach of any amendment or majority.

47 CITIZEN'S CHARTER

> A promise without a remedy is only a wish.

DEFINITION A public document stating the service standards, timelines and grievance-redressal mechanisms a citizen may expect from a department. Its weakness is that it is usually not legally enforceable, so it declares a right without giving a remedy.

KEYWORDS **service standards · timelines · grievance redressal**

QUOTES

- *"The Citizen's Charter is about giving more power to the citizen." — John Major*
- *"A promise without a remedy is a wish." — the standard critique of non-statutory charters*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A resident who cites the charter's stated timeline to demand action on a stalled water connection.
- An applicant who escalates on the exact date the charter allows, rather than waiting to be called.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Sevottam framework pushes departments to adopt charters with measurable standards and independent assessment.
- Passport Seva Kendras publish fixed service-delivery timelines and are among the few that meet them.
- The 2nd ARC recommended charters be made enforceable — and the Right of Citizens for Time Bound Delivery of Goods and Services Bill, 2011 lapsed without being passed.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

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- Several states — Madhya Pradesh first, then Bihar, Delhi and others — enacted Public Service Guarantee Acts that give charters legal teeth and penalise the officer who misses the deadline.
- CPGRAMS grievance-disposal timelines have been tightened and are now published ministry-wise, which is a charter enforced by dashboard rather than by statute.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The UK's 1991 Citizen's Charter inspired accountability frameworks across the Commonwealth.
- Singapore's e-government portals publish clear delivery timelines for each service.

48 RIGHT TO INFORMATION

> Secrecy became the exception, not the rule — on paper.

DEFINITION A statutory right allowing any citizen to seek information from public authorities, converting official secrecy from the norm into the exception. It is the tool that makes transparency operational.

KEYWORDS RTI Act 2005 · suo motu · Section 4

QUOTES

- *"Information is the currency of democracy." — Thomas Jefferson*
- *"A popular government without popular information, or the means of acquiring it, is but a prologue to a farce or a tragedy." — James Madison*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A citizen who files an RTI to find out why his pension file has not moved for eight months.
- A parent who uses RTI to obtain a school's mid-day-meal records.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- RTI activists have exposed irregularities in ration distribution and rural-employment funds that no audit had caught.
- Journalists have used RTI replies to uncover discrepancies in procurement contracts.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 amended Section 8(1)(j) of the RTI Act to exempt all personal information; critics argue this could shield precisely the records — officials' assets, beneficiary lists — that RTI was written to reach.
- Several State Information Commissions have functioned with heavy vacancies and long backlogs, and the Supreme Court has had to direct governments to fill them. A right with a two-year queue is not a right.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- More than 100 countries now have Freedom of Information laws.
- Sweden's Freedom of the Press Act (1766) was the world's first, and it is still the reference point.

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49 CODE OF ETHICS VS CODE OF CONDUCT

> Conduct sets the floor. Ethics sets the direction.

DEFINITION A code of conduct sets out enforceable do's and don'ts with penalties attached — it speaks to fear. A code of ethics states broader aspirational principles — it speaks to conviction. Conduct sets the floor; ethics sets the direction.

KEYWORDS enforceable vs aspirational · fear vs conviction

QUOTES

- *"Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have a right to do and what is right to do." — Potter Stewart (UPSC 2022)*
- *"Character is doing the right thing when nobody is looking." — J.C. Watts*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Following the office dress code is conduct; genuinely respecting a junior colleague is ethics.
- Not accepting a bribe is conduct; refusing a gift that is technically permissible is ethics.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The AIS (Conduct) Rules, 1968 are enforceable and specific; the Nolan Committee's Seven Principles of Public Life are aspirational and general.
- The 2nd ARC recommended a Public Service Code and a Public Services Bill; the draft Bill of 2007 was never enacted, so India still has conduct rules without a code of ethics.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Voluntary AI ethics charters published by technology companies sit alongside the EU AI Act's binding obligations — the clearest live demonstration of the difference between the two instruments.
- The IT Rules, 2021 converted what platforms had treated as voluntary community standards into enforceable compliance duties.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Multinationals typically maintain a binding conduct code and a separate, broader ethics statement.
- Hong Kong's civil-service code pairs strict conduct rules with a published statement of core values.

50 CONFLICT OF INTEREST

> You need not be corrupted. You need only look corruptible.

DEFINITION A situation in which an official's private interest could improperly influence the performance of a public duty. The conflict need only be apparent to a reasonable observer — actual wrongdoing is not required for the damage to be done.

KEYWORDS recusal · disclosure · revolving door · real or apparent

QUOTES

- *"No man can serve two masters." — Jesus Christ*
- *"Caesar's wife must be above suspicion." — Roman maxim, cited by the Supreme Court of India*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An auditor who recuses himself from auditing a company where his brother is a senior executive.

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- A judge who discloses a past association with a litigant and steps aside without being asked.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The 2nd ARC advised against nominating serving officials to the boards of public undertakings they regulate.
- Recusal, mandatory disclosure of pecuniary interest, and cooling-off periods are the three standard instruments; India applies the first two far more consistently than the third.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The 'revolving door' — regulators moving into the industries they regulated, and vice versa — remains largely unregulated in India, and is the most common structural conflict in financial and telecom regulation.
- Two US Federal Reserve officials resigned in 2021 after their personal trading during a policy-making period became public, though no rule had clearly been broken. The appearance was enough.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- WHO and drug-regulatory advisory panels require members to declare interests, and publish them.
- OECD guidelines treat conflict-of-interest management as the core of integrity systems, not a side issue.

ETHICS: FOUNDATIONS AND THEORIES

The frameworks you use to justify a decision. Learn which theory each answer needs.

51. Rights Theory (Libertarianism) · 52. Ethical Egoism · 53. Determinants Of Ethics · 54. Descriptive Ethics · 55. Metaethics · 56. Kohlberg'S Stages Of Moral Development · 57. Utilitarianism · 58. Deontological Ethics · 59. Virtue Ethics · 60. Categorical Imperative · 61. Consequentialism · 62. Moral Relativism

51 RIGHTS THEORY (LIBERTARIANISM)

> A right that yields to the majority is not a right.

DEFINITION An action is right if it respects the rights of everyone it affects. A person may act as she wishes so long as she violates no one else's rights. Rights function as trumps: they cannot be overridden merely because the majority would gain.

KEYWORDS **Locke · Nozick · rights as trumps · autonomy**

QUOTES

- *"Every man has a property in his own person; this nobody has a right to but himself." — John Locke*
- *"Individuals have rights, and there are things no person or group may do to them without violating those rights." — Robert Nozick*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Someone who spends lavishly and gives nothing to charity — ungenerous, but within his rights, and rights theory says that is the end of the matter.
- A person who refuses to disclose her medical history to an employer, even where disclosure would help her colleagues plan.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Puttaswamy judgment (2017) recognised privacy as a fundamental right, and the argument was framed almost entirely in rights-theory terms — the individual against the State.
- Due-process protections for an accused hold even when the public is certain of guilt, because a right that yields to public opinion is not a right.

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CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Resistance to vaccine mandates during COVID-19 — including Canada's trucker convoy protest of 2022 — was argued on rights-theory ground: bodily autonomy against collective welfare.
- The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 treats personal data as something the individual has a right over, not merely something the State may process for good ends.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Libertarian objections to lockdowns, framed as liberty against paternalism, in several Western democracies.
- The absolute prohibition on torture holds even where torture might extract information that saves lives — a right that outcomes cannot override.

52 ETHICAL EGOISM

> Self-interest is most dangerous when it speaks the language of altruism.

DEFINITION The view that a person's own self-interest is, and ought to be, the proper motive of all action. It is a normative claim, not merely a description: it says pursuing your own good is what you should do.

KEYWORDS Ayn Rand · self-interest as duty

QUOTES

- *"The purpose of morality is to teach you, not to suffer and die, but to enjoy yourself and live." — Ayn Rand*
- *"It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest." — Adam Smith*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A person who donates only when it earns public recognition or a tax deduction.
- An officer who takes on a high-visibility posting purely for the promotion it guarantees, and drops the file when the cameras leave.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Corporate lobbying for policy that benefits one firm, publicly framed as being good for the economy, is the standard case analysed through this lens.
- Departments that hoard data and credit rather than share it — rational for the department, costly for the citizen.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Vaccine nationalism in 2021: wealthy states pre-booked doses far beyond their populations while COVAX went short — every state acted in its own interest, and the collective outcome was worse for all, including them.
- The FTX collapse (2022) is the sharpest recent case: a founder who marketed himself as an effective altruist while running a fraud. Self-interest is at its most dangerous when it wears the language of altruism.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Foreign aid given only where it serves the donor's strategic interest, and withdrawn when it does not.
- Countries that free-ride on global emissions cuts, gaining the climate benefit without paying the cost.

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53 DETERMINANTS OF ETHICS

No single source — which is why ethics has to be argued, not looked up.

DEFINITION There is no single source of right and wrong. Ethics is shaped together by religion, moral intuition, culture and custom, upbringing and family, education, law and the Constitution, leadership and the example of others.

KEYWORDS **religion, intuition, culture, upbringing, law, leadership**

QUOTES

- *"God has no religion." — Mahatma Gandhi*
- *"The moral law within." — Immanuel Kant*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- The instinctive urge to help an injured stranger, with no deliberation at all — intuition as a determinant.
- A person raised in a strict household who carries that discipline into office long after the household is gone.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Preamble and the Fundamental Duties operate as a codified determinant of public ethics in India.
- A department takes its ethics from its head: the tone at the top determines what juniors think is normal, faster than any circular.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The algorithmic feed is now a determinant of ethics that no previous generation faced — what a person sees a hundred times a day shapes what they consider normal.
- NEP 2020 puts values and ethics back into the formal curriculum, treating school as a deliberate determinant rather than a neutral one.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Golden Rule appears across nearly every major faith, and functions as a shared cross-cultural determinant.
- Confucian respect for elders and duty continues to shape everyday ethical behaviour across East Asia — culture as a living determinant.

54 DESCRIPTIVE ETHICS

It records the world. It does not correct it.

DEFINITION The empirical study of what people actually believe to be right or wrong, and how they actually behave — without judging whether they are correct. It describes; normative ethics prescribes.

KEYWORDS **what people believe · empirical · no judgment**

QUOTES

- *"It is the mark of an educated mind to entertain a thought without accepting it." — Aristotle*
- *"Custom is the great guide of human life." — David Hume*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A researcher who surveys a village on attitudes to dowry in order to record belief, not to correct it.
- An officer who first maps what a community actually believes before designing a campaign to change it.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

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- Law Commission consultations on the death penalty record public attitudes as data, which is descriptive work feeding a normative decision.
- NCRB and NFHS surveys record what citizens believe and do, which is where policy design has to start.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- NFHS-5 (2019–21) found that roughly 45 per cent of women and 44 per cent of men agreed that a husband is justified in beating his wife in at least one circumstance. That is a descriptive finding, and it tells you why a law alone will not close the gap.
- Pew Research's surveys on religious tolerance in India, and the World Values Survey's tracking of attitudes to divorce and euthanasia, are pure descriptive ethics.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The World Values Survey tracks how moral attitudes differ across nations without ranking them.
- Anthropological studies that record a practice faithfully while withholding judgment on it.

55 METAETHICS

> Not which acts are right — what 'right' even means.

DEFINITION The study of what moral language means and whether moral claims can be true at all — not which acts are right, but what 'right' is. It asks whether moral facts exist independently of what anyone believes.

KEYWORDS **meaning of moral words · is-ought gap · universal vs relative**

QUOTES

- *"No one does wrong willingly." — Socrates*
- *"You cannot derive an ought from an is." — David Hume*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Two officers arguing whether corruption is wrong always and everywhere, or only wrong given the harm it causes here.
- A person asking whether 'lying is wrong' states a fact, or merely reports a strongly held social convention.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The debate over whether capital punishment is objectively unjust, or unjust only in a culture that has decided so, is metaethical rather than legal.
- Whether human dignity is discovered or constructed determines whether a right can ever be legislated away.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Whether an artificial intelligence can be a moral agent — or a moral patient owed consideration — is a live metaethical question that is about to become a policy question.
- UN human-rights forums repeatedly divide over whether rights are universal or culturally relative, which is a metaethical disagreement dressed as a diplomatic one.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Debates at the International Criminal Court over universal jurisdiction rest on whether justice is culturally bound.
- The Asian Values debate of the 1990s argued that human rights were a Western moral vocabulary rather than a universal one.

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56 KOHLBERG'S STAGES OF MORAL DEVELOPMENT

> Most adults stop at 'because it is the rule'.

DEFINITION Lawrence Kohlberg held that moral reasoning develops through three levels: pre-conventional (avoid punishment, seek reward), conventional (conform to social rules and law), and post-conventional (act on self-chosen universal principles, even against the law). Most adults stop at the conventional level.

KEYWORDS pre-conventional · conventional · post-conventional

QUOTES

- *"One has not only a legal but a moral responsibility to obey just laws. Conversely, one has a moral responsibility to disobey unjust laws." — Martin Luther King Jr.*
- *"Two things fill the mind with ever new and increasing admiration: the starry heavens above and the moral law within." — Immanuel Kant*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A child who shares a toy only to avoid punishment (pre-conventional) versus one who shares because it is fair (post-conventional).
- A driver who stops at a red light because a camera is watching (pre-conventional) versus one who stops on an empty road at 3 a.m. (conventional or higher).

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Raja Ram Mohan Roy opposed Sati against both prevailing law and custom — post-conventional reasoning in an Indian setting.
- An officer who follows a rule because it is the rule is at the conventional stage; one who refuses an unjust rule and records why has moved beyond it.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Climate activists who deliberately break the law and accept prosecution argue in explicitly post-conventional terms; the sharp public disagreement about them is really a disagreement about whether that reasoning is legitimate.
- Whistle-blowers who breach a confidentiality obligation to expose harm are the standard modern instance — and they show why post-conventional reasoning is uncomfortable for institutions.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Martin Luther King Jr. broke segregation laws on principle and accepted jail for it.
- Germany's White Rose group distributed anti-Nazi leaflets knowing the penalty was death.

57 UTILITARIANISM

> It counts everyone — and then it can average away a minority.

DEFINITION The right action is the one producing the greatest good for the greatest number. Bentham counted pleasure and pain equally; Mill distinguished higher from lower pleasures. Its strength is that it takes consequences seriously; its weakness is that it can justify sacrificing a minority.

KEYWORDS Bentham · Mill · greatest good, greatest number

QUOTES

- *"The greatest happiness of the greatest number is the foundation of morals and legislation." — Jeremy Bentham*

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- *"It is better to be a human being dissatisfied than a pig satisfied." — John Stuart Mill*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A doctor doing triage, treating the patients with the best chance of survival first in order to save the most lives.
- A manager who cuts a few roles to keep the firm solvent and protect the remaining jobs.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Demonetisation (2016) was defended as short-term pain for long-term collective gain — and is now the standard Indian case for asking who counted as part of 'the greatest number'.
- Vaccine prioritisation by age and comorbidity maximised lives saved, and in doing so knowingly deprioritised others.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The national lockdown of March 2020 was a utilitarian calculation — lives saved against livelihoods lost — and the migrant-worker crisis was the cost borne by those who were not in the majority being protected.
- The UK's NICE uses an explicit cost-per-quality-adjusted-life-year threshold to decide which treatments the NHS will fund, which is utilitarianism written into a formula and applied to real patients.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- COVAX allocated vaccines to save the most lives overall rather than to give every country an equal share.
- Trolley-problem reasoning in autonomous-vehicle regulation is utilitarianism applied to code.

58 DEONTOLOGICAL ETHICS

> Some acts are wrong even when they work.

DEFINITION Kant's view that morality lies in the motive and in duty, not in the outcome. Some acts are wrong in themselves, whatever good they might produce. The rightness of the act is judged by the rule it follows, not by the result it happens to bring about.

KEYWORDS **Kant · duty · motive over outcome · rule-based**

QUOTES

- *"Act only on that maxim whereby you can at the same time will that it should become a universal law." — Immanuel Kant*
- *"Duty for duty's sake." — Immanuel Kant*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A lawyer who refuses to lie in court even where the lie would acquit his client.
- A soldier who refuses to fire on unarmed civilians regardless of the order.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Courts uphold an accused's due-process rights even when the public demands instant punishment, because the right does not depend on the outcome.
- An officer who records the truth in a file knowing it will damage a scheme he believes in.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Doctors who refused to falsify death certificates during COVID-19, when correcting the count was inconvenient for everyone above them.
- Journalists who protect a source under legal pressure — the duty holds even where disclosure would produce a better immediate outcome.

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INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Geneva Conventions prohibit torture of prisoners of war unconditionally — no military advantage can license it.
- The Nuremberg Code (1947) requires informed consent in medical research regardless of how great the potential benefit.

59 VIRTUE ETHICS

> Not 'what should I do?' but 'what am I becoming?'

DEFINITION Aristotle's approach: judge the character of the person, not the rule or the outcome. Virtue is a mean between extremes (courage between cowardice and recklessness), and it becomes character only through repeated practice. Ask not 'what should I do?' but 'what kind of person am I becoming?'

KEYWORDS **Aristotle · character · habituation · golden mean**

QUOTES

- *"We are what we repeatedly do. Excellence, then, is not an act but a habit." — Aristotle (paraphrasing the Nicomachean Ethics)*
- *"Character is destiny." — Heraclitus*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A young officer who practises patience daily until it stops being an effort and becomes his temperament.
- A struggling scientist who refuses to leak confidential research to a rival firm, even knowing the same information will be public in a fortnight — the act changes nothing, the character changes everything.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- LBSNAA's Foundation Course stresses character formation rather than rules alone, on the Aristotelian assumption that a good officer will do the right thing in a situation no rule anticipated.
- The Gurukul tradition aimed at building character first and knowledge second.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Mission Karmayogi's competency framework tries to build behaviour and disposition, not just knowledge — a virtue-ethics premise inside an HR system.
- Reputations built over decades of consistent conduct, as with Ratan Tata's, illustrate the Aristotelian point: character is the accumulated residue of repeated choices, and it cannot be acquired in a crisis.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Confucian statecraft ties good governance directly to the personal virtue of the ruler.
- Aristotle's Lyceum was built on the idea that virtue is taught through habituation and practice, not through lecture.

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60 CATEGORICAL IMPERATIVE

> Would you sign the rule if everyone had to live under it?

DEFINITION Kant's supreme moral rule, in two of its formulations: act only on a maxim you could will to become a universal law; and treat humanity, whether in yourself or another, always as an end and never merely as a means.

KEYWORDS universalisability · ends, never merely means

QUOTES

- *"Human beings should be treated as ends, never merely as means." — Immanuel Kant (UPSC 2014)*
- *"So act that your principle of action might safely be made a law for the whole world." — Immanuel Kant*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A student who will not copy in an exam, because he cannot will a world in which everyone cheats — the practice would destroy the thing it exploits.
- A shopkeeper who charges the same fair price to the rich and the poor customer alike.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Minimum-wage law treats the worker as an end, not merely as an input to production.
- A scheme that treats beneficiaries as numbers to be reported, rather than as people to be served, fails the second formulation exactly.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- India's Surrogacy (Regulation) Act, 2021 permits only altruistic surrogacy and bans the commercial kind — the reasoning is Kantian: a woman's body must not become a means to another's end.
- The prohibition on organ trade rests on the same principle, and the persistence of the black market shows how hard the principle is to hold.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The ILO's core conventions ban child labour absolutely, with no exception for a country's economic circumstances.
- The ban on slavery admits of no cost-benefit exception in any human-rights instrument.

61 CONSEQUENTIALISM

> Whoever chooses which consequence to count has already won the argument.

DEFINITION Judging an action purely by its results rather than by the intention or the rule behind it — also called teleological ethics. Utilitarianism is its best-known form, but not the only one.

KEYWORDS teleological · results over rules · ends and means

QUOTES

- *"The true rule, in determining to embrace or reject anything, is not whether it have any evil in it, but whether it have more of evil than of good." — Abraham Lincoln (UPSC 2018)*
- *"The end justifies the means" — the crude form of the doctrine, and the reason it needs limits.*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A whistle-blower who leaks confidential data, judging that the public good outweighs the breach.
- A parent who allows a child a small lie to spare them unnecessary distress, weighing only the outcome.

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ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Land acquired under eminent domain for a highway, justified by the developmental outcome for a far larger number.
- A crackdown that reduces crime figures while damaging community trust — good on the metric chosen, bad on the one not chosen.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Lockdown decisions were defended and attacked almost entirely on consequences: cases prevented versus livelihoods destroyed. Whoever chose which consequence to count had already decided the argument.
- Content moderation on platforms is consequentialist by design — remove the post if the projected harm exceeds the speech value — and that is exactly why it satisfies nobody.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Humanitarian intervention justified on the argument that it prevents a greater loss of life than it causes.
- Sanctions regimes, defended by their intended outcome and criticised for the civilian suffering they actually produce.

62 MORAL RELATIVISM

> It buys tolerance by surrendering the right to condemn cruelty.

DEFINITION The view that right and wrong are not fixed but vary across cultures and individuals, and that no external standard can adjudicate between them. Its appeal is tolerance; its problem is that it disarms criticism of any practice, including cruelty.

KEYWORDS culture-bound · no external standard

QUOTES

- *"When in Rome, do as the Romans do." — St. Ambrose*
- *"A morality of relative emotional values is a mere illusion." — Socrates (UPSC 2020)*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Adjusting one's gift-giving customs to the cultural setting one is in.
- Withholding judgment on an unfamiliar practice until one has understood its context — while still reserving the right to judge it afterwards.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Uniform Civil Code debates are precisely the tension between a universal standard and relative community norms.
- Personal laws that differ by community are relativism institutionalised; Article 44 is the counter-argument written into the Constitution.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Uttarakhand's Uniform Civil Code came into force on 27 January 2025, making it the first state to legislate a common code — the live test of whether one standard can replace many.
- Practices such as female genital mutilation are defended in some societies as culture and prosecuted in others as violence. Relativism has no way to settle that, which is its limitation, not a detail.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- UN forums disagree permanently over capital punishment, which some members regard as a legal choice and others as a rights violation.

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- France restricts religious dress in public institutions while Iran mandates it — same garment, opposite compulsions, each justified as cultural.

INDIAN THOUGHT

Gandhi and the Gita. The examiner expects these, and most scripts use them badly.

63. Ahimsa · 64. Satyagraha · 65. Trusteeship · 66. Sarvodaya · 67. Nishkama Karma · 68. Swadharma · 69. Karma Yoga

63 AHIMSA

> Not passivity — the active refusal to injure.

DEFINITION Non-violence in thought, word and deed towards all living beings. Central to Jain, Buddhist and Gandhian thought. Gandhi's insistence was that ahimsa is not passivity — it is the active refusal to injure, which requires more courage than retaliation.

KEYWORDS **thought, word and deed · Jain, Buddhist, Gandhian**

QUOTES

- *"Non-violence is the greatest force at the disposal of mankind. It is mightier than the mightiest weapon of destruction devised by the ingenuity of man." — Mahatma Gandhi*
- *"Non-violence is not a garment to be put on and off at will. Its seat is in the heart." — Mahatma Gandhi*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- Walking away from an argument that is escalating, rather than winning it.
- Refusing to humiliate a subordinate in front of others, even when the reprimand is deserved — violence includes words.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Gandhi built the freedom struggle on ahimsa as both a moral commitment and a political strategy, and insisted the two could not be separated.
- Police doctrine on minimum use of force is ahimsa translated into standard operating procedure.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Non-violent civil resistance remains the most effective form of mass protest — Myanmar's civil disobedience movement after the 2021 coup, and Iran's protests, were sustained by ordinary people who refused to be provoked into giving the State its excuse.
- The rise of ethical vegetarianism and veganism worldwide is ahimsa extended from a religious duty to an environmental and animal-welfare argument.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Dalai Lama's non-violent resistance for Tibet is explicitly grounded in ahimsa.
- Martin Luther King Jr. adopted Gandhian non-violence as the operating philosophy of the American civil rights movement.

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64 SATYAGRAHA

> The satyagrahi's power is that he will not hit back.

DEFINITION Gandhi's method of resisting injustice through truth-force — non-violent, open, and willing to suffer the consequences. The satyagrahi does not seek to defeat the opponent but to convert him; suffering is accepted, never inflicted.

KEYWORDS truth-force · suffering accepted, not inflicted · convert, not defeat

QUOTES

- *"Satyagraha vindicates truth by the infliction of suffering not on the opponent but on oneself." — Mahatma Gandhi*
- *"Violence is the fear of other people's ideas." — Jawaharlal Nehru*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An employee who refuses to sign a fraudulent document and accepts the professional consequence, without turning it into a confrontation.
- A citizen who breaks an unjust rule openly and reports himself, rather than evading it quietly.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The 1930 Dandi Salt March broke an unjust tax law openly, deliberately and non-violently — the classic satyagraha.
- Champaran (1917) and Kheda (1918) were the earlier campaigns that established the method: investigate, negotiate, then resist, and never conceal.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Long-running peaceful agitations that end in negotiated settlement, rather than in force, follow the satyagraha logic: the movement's authority comes from its restraint, and it is lost the moment violence enters.
- Environmental and land-rights movements that use courts and non-violent occupation together are its modern institutional form.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Nelson Mandela's anti-apartheid resistance drew explicitly on Gandhian methods in its early phase.
- The Solidarity movement in Poland brought down a regime without an armed uprising.

65 TRUSTEESHIP

> The rich are custodians, not owners.

DEFINITION Gandhi's doctrine that wealth beyond one's needs is held in trust for society. The rich are not owners but trustees, and their surplus is a social resource in their custody. It rejects both the expropriation of the communist and the entitlement of the capitalist.

KEYWORDS surplus held in trust · CSR · voluntary

QUOTES

- *"The rich should hold their riches in trust for the welfare of the poor." — Mahatma Gandhi*
- *"The earth provides enough to satisfy every man's need, but not every man's greed." — Mahatma Gandhi*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

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- A wealthy individual who funds a scholarship trust from personal earnings and takes no credit for it.
- A landowner who allows landless families to cultivate a portion of his surplus land.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The CSR mandate under Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013 is trusteeship converted into statute — which arguably proves Gandhi's point and defeats it at once, since a trusteeship that must be compelled is no longer trusteeship.
- The Tata Trusts model, where a large share of company profits funds public charitable work, is the closest Indian institutional realisation of the idea.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Azim Premji has transferred the bulk of his Wipro holdings to his foundation — among the largest philanthropic endowments anywhere, and unusual in being irreversible rather than pledged.
- Indian companies now spend well over Rs 25,000 crore a year on mandated CSR; the open question is whether compelled giving builds the moral habit Gandhi wanted, or substitutes for it.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Giving Pledge commits billionaires to giving away the majority of their wealth — a voluntary trusteeship.
- Andrew Carnegie's 1889 essay 'The Gospel of Wealth' argued that the rich are merely trustees of their fortune, obliged to use it for the community in their own lifetime.

66 SARVODAYA

> Not the greatest number. Every one — starting with the last.

DEFINITION Gandhi's ideal of the welfare of all — not the greatest good of the greatest number, but the good of every one, including the last. Where utilitarianism can average away a minority, Sarvodaya explicitly refuses to.

KEYWORDS **welfare of all · antyodaya · the last person**

QUOTES

- *"The good of the individual is contained in the good of all." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2013)*
- *"Recall the face of the poorest and weakest man you have seen, and ask yourself if the step you contemplate is going to be of any use to him." — Mahatma Gandhi's talisman*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A social worker who checks that the most marginalised household in the village is enrolled before declaring the programme complete.
- A teacher who plans her lesson around the slowest learner rather than the brightest.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Antyodaya Anna Yojana explicitly targets the poorest of the poor first, which is Sarvodaya as a delivery principle.
- Vinoba Bhave's Bhoodan movement sought voluntary land redistribution in the same spirit — persuasion, not expropriation.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- PM-JANMAN (November 2023) targets Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups — the communities that almost every earlier scheme reached last, if at all. Reaching them first is the whole point.
- The Aspirational Blocks Programme (2023) deliberately concentrates effort on the worst-performing units rather than on the ones that will improve the national average fastest.

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INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Sustainable Development Goals' pledge to 'leave no one behind' is Sarvodaya restated in UN language.
- Sri Lanka's Sarvodaya Shramadana movement, founded by A.T. Ariyaratne, grew into one of Asia's largest grassroots development networks.

67 NISHKAMA KARMA

> Work that does not stop when the reward is withheld.

DEFINITION The Gita's teaching of desireless action — performing one's duty fully while renouncing attachment to the fruit of it. It does not mean indifference to outcomes; it means the work is not done for the reward, so it does not stop when the reward is withheld.

KEYWORDS **Gita 2.47 · duty without attachment to fruit**

QUOTES

- *"You have a right to perform your prescribed duty, but you are not entitled to the fruits of action." — Bhagavad Gita 2.47*
- *"A man is made by his belief. As he believes, so he is." — Swami Vivekananda*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A teacher who mentors a struggling student for years and never claims the credit when the student succeeds.
- An officer who completes a project knowing his successor will inaugurate it.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Health workers who administered polio drops for years, in the same lanes, for a certificate that named no one.
- Anganwadi workers who continue in remote areas on modest honoraria, long past the point where incentive explains it.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The rat-hole miners at Silkyara (November 2023) crawled into an unstable tunnel that machines had failed in, brought out 41 men, and went home. Most of the country cannot name one of them.
- Anonymous organ and blood donors, and the volunteers who staffed COVID helplines through 2021, worked with no prospect of being identified at all.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Long-serving humanitarian volunteers in crisis zones who never seek public recognition.
- Mother Teresa's decades of work among Kolkata's poorest, sought neither wealth nor position, is cited abroad as Nishkama Karma in practice.

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68 SWADHARMA

> Better your own duty done badly than another's done well.

DEFINITION One's own duty, appropriate to one's own nature, station and role — as against another's duty, however attractive. The Gita's counsel is that a duty imperfectly performed but genuinely one's own is better than another's duty performed well.

KEYWORDS Gita 3.35 · role fidelity · separation of powers

QUOTES

- *"Better is one's own duty, though imperfectly performed, than the duty of another well discharged." — Bhagavad Gita 3.35*
- *"Do your duty; leave the rest to time." — Mahatma Gandhi*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A civil servant who confines himself to his administrative role instead of straying into political advocacy.
- A judge who limits himself to interpreting the law rather than writing the policy he would prefer.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The separation of powers is institutional swadharma: legislature, executive and judiciary each keeping to the role the Constitution assigns.
- The AIS Conduct Rules bar officers from public political commentary — the office has its own dharma, and a private opinion is not part of it.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Judicial overreach and executive encroachment are both swadharma failures, and the collegium debate is the standing example of two institutions each arguing that the other has left its lane.
- The 'cooling-off' expectation before an officer enters politics exists to keep the two dharmas from contaminating each other.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The principle of subsidiarity leaves matters to the level of government best suited to them.
- Doctors Without Borders confines itself strictly to medical relief and refuses political involvement in host countries — a professional swadharma.

69 KARMA YOGA

> Worth lies in the doing, not in the rank of the job.

DEFINITION Work itself as a spiritual discipline — performed with full dedication, without ego, and offered as service rather than as a transaction. It dignifies labour by locating worth in the doing, not in the status of the job.

KEYWORDS work is worship · dignity of labour · ego-less service

QUOTES

- *"Work is worship." — Swami Vivekananda*
- *"They alone live who live for others; the rest are more dead than alive." — Swami Vivekananda*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A sanitation worker who takes real pride in his work despite receiving no recognition for it.

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- A clerk who keeps a difficult file moving because it belongs to someone who cannot follow it up himself.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Vivekananda's call that service to man is service to God inspired the social-service missions that still run schools and hospitals across India.
- Railway trackmen who maintain safety through the night, doing unglamorous work that is only ever noticed when it fails.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The NAMASTE scheme (2023) aims to mechanise sewer and septic-tank cleaning and end the practice of humans entering them. Karma yoga dignifies the worker's attitude to his labour; the State's duty is to ensure the labour itself is not degrading.
- Gig and platform workers doing invisible, algorithmically-directed work raise the same question in a new form — whether the dignity is in the worker or has to be built into the job.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Disaster-relief volunteers who describe gruelling work as fulfilling rather than burdensome.
- Japan's idea of ikigai frames daily work as a source of purpose rather than mere livelihood — the same spirit reached by a different road.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUES

Where ethics meets today's headlines — gender, environment, technology, business.

70. Gender Sensitization · 71. Environmental Ethics · 72. Cyber Ethics · 73. Corporate Social Responsibility

70 GENDER SENSITIZATION

> Law reaches behaviour. Only sensitisation reaches the attitude behind it.

DEFINITION Building awareness and changing attitudes so that all genders are treated with equal dignity and opportunity. Sensitisation aims at the attitude behind the behaviour; law can only reach the behaviour.

KEYWORDS **equal dignity · POSH Act · attitude before law**

QUOTES

- *"Gender equality is more than a goal in itself. It is a precondition for meeting the challenge of reducing poverty." — Kofi Annan*
- *"Gender equality is not only a women's issue, it is a human issue." — Ban Ki-moon*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A father who shares household work equally with his working wife, without describing it as helping her.
- A manager who notices that women are being interrupted in meetings, and stops it.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The POSH Act, 2013 requires Internal Committees at every workplace; the persistent failure of many institutions to constitute them is itself the lesson.
- Joyita Mondal became India's first transgender judge, appointed to a Lok Adalat in West Bengal in 2017.
- The Supreme Court's 2020 ruling granting permanent commission to women officers, and the admission of women cadets to the NDA, ended a formal exclusion that had outlived every justification offered for it.

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CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam (106th Amendment, 2023) reserves one-third of seats in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies for women — passed almost unanimously, but operative only after a census and delimitation.
- Paris 2024 was the first Olympic Games with equal quota places for men and women athletes.
- The Taliban's bar on girls' secondary and university education, and on women working for NGOs, is the sharpest contemporary reversal anywhere in the world.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Nordic countries' non-transferable parental leave for fathers is the most effective gender-sensitisation policy yet designed, because it changes what men do, not only what they believe.
- Rwanda's parliament has the world's highest share of women legislators, a deliberate post-genocide design choice.

71 ENVIRONMENTAL ETHICS

> Our obligations run to people who cannot bargain with us.

DEFINITION The branch of ethics concerned with the moral relationship between humans and nature, and with our obligations to future generations who cannot bargain with us. It asks whether nature has value in itself (deep ecology) or only value for us (anthropocentrism).

KEYWORDS **intergenerational equity · Public Trust Doctrine · anthropocentric vs deep ecology**

QUOTES

- *"The environment and the economy are really both two sides of the same coin. If we cannot sustain the environment, we cannot sustain ourselves." — Wangari Maathai*
- *"We do not inherit the earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children." — attributed as a Native American proverb*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A homeowner who composts kitchen waste despite the daily inconvenience.
- A commuter who switches to public transport specifically to cut his own emissions, knowing his individual contribution is negligible — which is precisely the ethical point.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The Supreme Court's Public Trust Doctrine holds rivers, forests and air as a common inheritance the State merely holds in trust — it cannot alienate them.
- Environmental clearance processes exist to force the intergenerational question into a decision that would otherwise only count present-day rupees.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Mission LiFE (2022) shifts part of the climate burden onto individual lifestyle, which is either a democratisation of responsibility or a displacement of it, depending on who you ask.
- COP28 (2023) produced the first explicit global call to transition away from fossil fuels and operationalised the Loss and Damage Fund — an admission that those least responsible for emissions are suffering most from them.
- India's pledge of net zero by 2070, made at COP26, raises the core equity question: whether a country that industrialised late owes the same timeline as one that industrialised first.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The Paris Agreement (2015) binds nations to limit warming for the benefit of people not yet born.

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- New Zealand granted the Whanganui River legal personhood in 2017, and Ecuador wrote rights of nature into its constitution — the law beginning to treat nature as a subject, not an object.

72 CYBER ETHICS

> The technology moves faster than the norm, and far faster than the law.

DEFINITION The moral principles governing the use of computers, the internet, data and artificial intelligence — covering privacy, consent, intellectual property, anonymity, misinformation and algorithmic harm. Its difficulty is that the technology moves faster than the norm, and far faster than the law.

KEYWORDS **privacy · consent · deepfakes · algorithmic harm**

QUOTES

- *"The Internet is becoming the town square for the global village of tomorrow." — Bill Gates*
- *"The rise of powerful AI will be either the best or the worst thing ever to happen to humanity." — Stephen Hawking*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- An engineer who reports a security flaw responsibly instead of selling it or exploiting it.
- A student who cites her sources instead of passing off generated text as her own work.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- The IT Rules, 2021 place due-diligence and grievance obligations on intermediaries for harmful content.
- The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 establishes consent, purpose limitation and data-fiduciary duties — and its exemptions for the State are where the ethical argument now sits.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- A deepfake video of the actor Rashmika Mandanna went viral in November 2023 and forced the government to issue advisories to platforms; deepfakes have since moved from celebrities to ordinary women, and to political speech.
- 'Digital arrest' scams — in which fraudsters impersonate police or agencies over video call and extort victims in real time — have become common enough that the Prime Minister warned the public about them directly.
- The EU AI Act, in force from August 2024, takes a risk-based approach and bans certain uses outright, such as social scoring — the first binding attempt anywhere to draw an ethical line in law.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- The right to be forgotten, established in EU law, treats the permanence of digital memory as itself a harm.
- Whether AI training on copyrighted work without consent is fair use or expropriation is being litigated worldwide, with no settled answer.

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73 CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

> The question has moved from what a company gives away to how it earns.

DEFINITION A company's commitment to operate ethically and contribute to society beyond generating profit — balancing the interests of shareholders against those of employees, consumers, communities and the environment. The standing question is whether responsibility that is mandated can still be called responsibility.

KEYWORDS beyond profit · Section 135 · ESG · greenwashing

QUOTES

- *"The social responsibility of business is to increase its profits — so long as it stays within the rules of the game." — Milton Friedman*
- *"A business that makes nothing but money is a poor kind of business." — Henry Ford*

PERSONAL EXAMPLES

- A small business owner who sources only from suppliers verified free of child labour, and pays more for it.
- A restaurant that donates its unsold, edible food to a shelter every night rather than discarding it.

ADMINISTRATIVE EXAMPLES

- Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013 requires eligible companies to spend two per cent of average net profit on CSR — India was the first country to mandate this by law.
- SEBI's Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report is mandatory for the top listed companies, moving CSR from a charity line into an audited disclosure.

CONTEMPORARY EXAMPLES

- Greenwashing is now the central CSR problem: SEBI has had to act against misleading environmental claims in green-bond disclosures, because the reporting became the product.
- The debate has shifted from what a company gives away to how it earns — supply-chain labour, emissions and data practices matter more than the school it builds.

INTERNATIONAL EXAMPLES

- Global apparel brands were forced to audit their supply chains after the Rana Plaza collapse in Bangladesh killed over 1,100 garment workers in 2013.
- The UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights make respect for rights a corporate responsibility independent of what the host state requires.

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RECALL AND REVISION

Reading these notes again is the least effective thing you can do with them. Retrieval beats re-reading, and it is not close. Use this section to pull the term out of your head before you look at it.

1 · RAPID REVISION TABLE

Cover the two right-hand columns. Read the term. Say the core idea and the example aloud. Then check.

#	TERM	CORE IDEA	GO-TO EXAMPLE
1	**Aptitude**	Intelligence gets you the marks. Aptitude gets the decision right at 2 a.m.	Chandrayaan-3, built on Chandrayaan-2's failure analysis
2	**Integrity**	Integrity is what your file says when nobody will ever read it.	Shastri resigning over a rail accident
3	**Intellectual Integrity**	The willingness to be proved wrong — in public, at your own cost.	The Lancet retracting its own hydroxychloroquine study (2020)
4	**Probity**	Not merely above prosecution. Above suspicion.	Justice Sikri withdrawing consent for a tribunal post
5	**Honesty**	The cheapest virtue to praise, the hardest to practise when it costs.	Operation Amanat — RPF returning lost valuables
6	**Objectivity**	Deciding what is true before deciding what you want to be true.	Kennedy in the Cuban Missile Crisis (1962)
7	**Impartiality**	Not merely being fair — being visibly, checkably fair.	ECI notices to both ruling party and opposition, 2024
8	**Non-Partisanship**	Serve the government of the day. Never become its party worker.	T.N. Seshan as CEC; O.P. Chowdhary refusing all parties alike
9	**Tolerance**	Tolerance is not agreeing. It is not needing the other person to agree.	A Kerala church sheltering temple idols during the 2018 floods
10	**Courage And Fearlessness**	Courage is doing your duty with your hands shaking.	P.S. Appu resigning rather than dilute LBSNAA reforms
11	**Fortitude**	Courage lasts a moment. Fortitude has to last a year.	41 workers, 17 days, Silkyara tunnel (2023)
12	**Conscience**	The voice that speaks when the rulebook has gone quiet.	Journalists reporting through Emergency censorship
13	**Crisis Of Conscience**	Not right versus wrong — that is temptation. This is every door costing you something.	Doctors allocating the last oxygen bed, April 2021
14	**Dedication To Public Service**	The job is measured by what the citizen receives, not by what the rules require.	ASHA workers — WHO Global Health Leaders Award, 2022
15	**Altruism**	Help that cannot be traced back to you.	Oxygen langars and community kitchens, 2021
16	**Forbearance**	Strength that declines to use itself.	NATO's measured response to the Przewodów missile, 2022
17	**Trustworthiness And Public Trust**	Trust arrives on foot and leaves on horseback.	UPI crossing 10 billion transactions in a month

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#	TERM	CORE IDEA	GO-TO EXAMPLE
18	**Sportsmanship**	Respect for the opponent survives the result.	Neeraj Chopra and Arshad Nadeem, Paris 2024
19	**Duty Vs Obligation**	An obligation can be discharged. Only a duty can be exceeded.	The rat-hole miners at Silkyara — no obligation at all
20	**Socialization And Its Agencies**	Nobody is taught ethics. Everybody absorbs them.	Australia's under-16 social media ban (2024)
21	**Conformity**	People will deny what their own eyes see rather than stand alone.	Online pile-ons; retail herding in meme stocks
22	**Obedience**	Evil rarely needs villains. It needs people who file the paperwork.	Jallianwala Bagh; the Nuremberg defence
23	**Persuasion**	Changing a mind is cheaper than changing a law.	200 crore vaccine doses — persuasion, not mandate
24	**Bureaucratic Vs Democratic Attitude**	Rule-bound in the emergency. Participative in the plan.	NDMA protocol versus Kerala's People's Plan Campaign
25	**Intuition**	Intuition is recognition — and only as good as the experience behind it.	Gandhi calling off Non-Cooperation after Chauri Chaura
26	**Cooperation**	Most administrative failure is coordination failure wearing a technical mask.	Silkyara (worked) versus Meghalaya rat-hole mining (did not)
27	**Emotional Intelligence**	IQ gets you the post. EQ gets you the cooperation.	Collector Prashant settling the Kozhikode market dispute
28	**Self-Awareness**	You are the easiest person you will ever fool.	Competency and feedback modules under Mission Karmayogi
29	**Self-Regulation**	Between stimulus and response lies your entire reputation.	Officers who refuse to answer online abuse in kind
30	**Empathy**	Sympathy feels for. Empathy feels with.	Wayanad 2024 — DNA matching and dignified burial of the unidentified
31	**Compassion**	Empathy that stays in the chair is only a feeling.	DM Swati Bhadauria enrolling her own son in an anganwadi
32	**Prejudice**	An opinion formed before the evidence arrives — and defended after it does.	Amazon's AI recruiting tool downgrading women's résumés
33	**Cognitive Dissonance**	We do not change the behaviour. We change the story.	COP28's fossil-fuel call, hosted by a major oil producer
34	**Ethical Dilemma**	Right versus wrong is temptation. Right versus right is a dilemma.	One ventilator, two equally critical patients
35	**Hatred And Intolerance**	Hatred is never spontaneous. It is manufactured — and it is always cheap.	Rwanda; Manipur 2023
36	**Transparency**	Without transparency, accountability is voluntary.	Electoral bonds struck down, February 2024
37	**Accountability**	Answerability without consequence is theatre.	Balasore, 2023 — set against Shastri, 1956
38	**Whistleblowing**	The system's immune response usually targets the whistle-blower, not the disease.	Satyendra Dubey (murdered, 2003); Frances Haugen (2021)
39	**Corruption**	The certificate existed. The inspection did not.	Morbi bridge collapse, 2022 — 135 dead, clearance on paper

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#	TERM	CORE IDEA	GO-TO EXAMPLE
40	**Nepotism**	Merit is what you lose when the shortlist is a family tree.	Dynastic candidate selection across parties
41	**Public Interest**	Everyone claims it, so it must be argued — never merely asserted.	India and South Africa's TRIPS waiver proposal, 2020
42	**Rule Of Law**	Punishment without trial is not open to the executive.	Supreme Court guidelines against demolitions, November 2024
43	**Social Justice**	Judge the institution by how it treats the last person, not the average one.	Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam (2023); SC sub-classification (2024)
44	**Good Governance**	Good governance asks only whether the machine runs.	Aspirational Districts and Blocks Programme
45	**Ethical Governance**	An efficient unjust decision is still unjust.	Kerala's People's Plan; the EU AI Act
46	**Constitutional Morality**	The Constitution's morality — not the majority's.	Navtej Singh Johar, 2018
47	**Citizen'S Charter**	A promise without a remedy is only a wish.	State Public Service Guarantee Acts (MP first)
48	**Right To Information**	Secrecy became the exception, not the rule — on paper.	The DPDP Act's amendment to Section 8(1)(j)
49	**Code Of Ethics Vs Code Of Conduct**	Conduct sets the floor. Ethics sets the direction.	AIS Conduct Rules versus the Nolan Principles
50	**Conflict Of Interest**	You need not be corrupted. You need only look corruptible.	The regulator's revolving door; Fed officials resigning, 2021
51	**Rights Theory (Libertarianism)**	A right that yields to the majority is not a right.	Puttaswamy, 2017 — privacy as a fundamental right
52	**Ethical Egoism**	Self-interest is most dangerous when it speaks the language of altruism.	Vaccine nationalism, 2021; the FTX collapse
53	**Determinants Of Ethics**	No single source — which is why ethics has to be argued, not looked up.	The algorithmic feed as a new determinant
54	**Descriptive Ethics**	It records the world. It does not correct it.	NFHS-5 on attitudes to wife-beating
55	**Metaethics**	Not which acts are right — what 'right' even means.	Are human rights universal, or a Western vocabulary?
56	**Kohlberg'S Stages Of Moral Development**	Most adults stop at 'because it is the rule'.	MLK breaking segregation law on principle
57	**Utilitarianism**	It counts everyone — and then it can average away a minority.	Lockdown 2020; NICE's cost-per-life-year formula
58	**Deontological Ethics**	Some acts are wrong even when they work.	The Geneva Conventions' absolute ban on torture
59	**Virtue Ethics**	Not 'what should I do?' but 'what am I becoming?'	Refusing to leak research that will be public in a fortnight anyway
60	**Categorical Imperative**	Would you sign the rule if everyone had to live under it?	Surrogacy (Regulation) Act, 2021 — altruistic only
61	**Consequentialism**	Whoever chooses which consequence to count has already won the argument.	Lockdown debates; platform content moderation
62	**Moral Relativism**	It buys tolerance by surrendering the right to condemn cruelty.	Uttarakhand's UCC, in force January 2025

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#	TERM	CORE IDEA	GO-TO EXAMPLE
63	**Ahimsa**	Not passivity — the active refusal to injure.	Gandhi's freedom struggle; MLK's civil rights movement
64	**Satyagraha**	The satyagrahi's power is that he will not hit back.	The Dandi Salt March, 1930
65	**Trusteeship**	The rich are custodians, not owners.	Azim Premji transferring the bulk of his Wipro holdings
66	**Sarvodaya**	Not the greatest number. Every one — starting with the last.	PM-JANMAN for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups, 2023
67	**Nishkama Karma**	Work that does not stop when the reward is withheld.	The Silkyara rat-hole miners — nobody can name one of them
68	**Swadharma**	Better your own duty done badly than another's done well.	Judiciary, executive and legislature keeping to their lanes
69	**Karma Yoga**	Worth lies in the doing, not in the rank of the job.	Railway trackmen; the NAMASTE scheme, 2023
70	**Gender Sensitization**	Law reaches behaviour. Only sensitisation reaches the attitude behind it.	Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam (2023); gender parity at Paris 2024
71	**Environmental Ethics**	Our obligations run to people who cannot bargain with us.	COP28's Loss and Damage Fund; net zero by 2070
72	**Cyber Ethics**	The technology moves faster than the norm, and far faster than the law.	Deepfakes and digital-arrest scams; the EU AI Act, 2024
73	**Corporate Social Responsibility**	The question has moved from what a company gives away to how it earns.	Rana Plaza; SEBI's BRSR disclosure

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2 · QUOTE BANK

One quote per term — the one worth carrying into the hall. A quote earns its place only where it does work in the argument.

#	TERM	QUOTE
1	**Aptitude**	*"Vision without action is merely a dream." — Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam*
2	**Integrity**	*"Integrity is doing the right thing, even when no one is watching." — C.S. Lewis*
3	**Intellectual Integrity**	*"An unexamined life is not worth living." — Socrates (UPSC 2019)*
4	**Probity**	*"An honest man's word is as good as his bond." — Miguel de Cervantes*
5	**Honesty**	*"Honesty is the first chapter in the book of wisdom." — Thomas Jefferson*
6	**Objectivity**	*"Facts do not cease to exist because they are ignored." — Aldous Huxley*
7	**Impartiality**	*"Justice delayed is justice denied." — William E. Gladstone*
8	**Non-Partisanship**	*"The Indian Civil Service is the steel frame which holds together the political and social structure of India." — David Lloyd George*
9	**Tolerance**	*"Anger and intolerance are the enemies of correct understanding." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2018)*
10	**Courage And Fearlessness**	*"Courage is not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it." — Nelson Mandela*
11	**Fortitude**	*"If you want to test a man's character, give him power." — Abraham Lincoln (UPSC 2013)*
12	**Conscience**	*"Conscience is a man's compass." — Vincent van Gogh*
13	**Crisis Of Conscience**	*"Conscience does make cowards of us all." — William Shakespeare*
14	**Dedication To Public Service**	*"The service of India means the service of the poor." — Jawaharlal Nehru*
15	**Altruism**	*"The best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2020)*
16	**Forbearance**	*"Patience is bitter, but its fruit is sweet." — Aristotle*
17	**Trustworthiness And Public Trust**	*"Trust is the glue of life. It is the most essential ingredient in effective communication." — Stephen R. Covey*
18	**Sportsmanship**	*"The most important thing is not to win but to take part." — Pierre de Coubertin*
19	**Duty Vs Obligation**	*"Do your duty; leave the rest to time." — Mahatma Gandhi*
20	**Socialization And Its Agencies**	*"Whoever I am today, and whatever I will be tomorrow, I owe to my angel mother." — Abraham Lincoln*
21	**Conformity**	*"Whenever you find yourself on the side of the majority, it is time to pause and reflect." — Mark Twain*
22	**Obedience**	*"Obedience is the psychological mechanism that links individual action to political purpose." — Stanley Milgram*
23	**Persuasion**	*"If you would win a man to your cause, first convince him that you are his sincere friend." — Abraham Lincoln*
24	**Bureaucratic Vs Democratic Attitude**	*"Rules are not necessarily sacred, principles are." — Franklin D. Roosevelt*
25	**Intuition**	*"The intuitive mind is a sacred gift and the rational mind is a faithful servant." — Albert Einstein*
26	**Cooperation**	*"Alone we can do so little; together we can do so much." — Helen Keller*

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#	TERM	QUOTE
27	**Emotional Intelligence**	*"The success of any organisation depends 80 per cent on EQ and 20 per cent on IQ." — Daniel Goleman*
28	**Self-Awareness**	*"Knowing yourself is the beginning of all wisdom." — Aristotle*
29	**Self-Regulation**	*"He who reigns within himself and rules his passions is more than a king." — John Milton*
30	**Empathy**	*"Empathy is seeing with the eyes of another, listening with the ears of another, and feeling with the heart of another." — Alfred Adler*
31	**Compassion**	*"Love and compassion are necessities, not luxuries. Without them humanity cannot survive." — Dalai Lama*
32	**Prejudice**	*"Prejudice is what fools use for reason." — Voltaire*
33	**Cognitive Dissonance**	*"A man convinced against his will is of the same opinion still." — Benjamin Franklin*
34	**Ethical Dilemma**	*"The test of a first-rate intelligence is the ability to hold two opposed ideas in mind at the same time and still retain the ability to function." — F. Scott Fitzgerald*
35	**Hatred And Intolerance**	*"Hatred is never appeased by hatred; hatred is appeased by love alone." — Gautama Buddha (Dhammapada)*
36	**Transparency**	*"Sunlight is said to be the best of disinfectants; electric light the most efficient policeman." — Louis Brandeis*
37	**Accountability**	*"Power tends to corrupt, and absolute power corrupts absolutely." — Lord Acton*
38	**Whistleblowing**	*"The public has a right to know what its government is doing in its name." — Daniel Ellsberg*
39	**Corruption**	*"Corruption is a cancer that eats away at a citizen's faith in democracy." — Joe Biden*
40	**Nepotism**	*"Nothing is politically right which is morally wrong." — Daniel O'Connell*
41	**Public Interest**	*"The good of the people is the greatest law." — Cicero*
42	**Rule Of Law**	*"Be you never so high, the law is above you." — Lord Denning*
43	**Social Justice**	*"Justice is the first virtue of social institutions, as truth is of systems of thought." — John Rawls*
44	**Good Governance**	*"Good governance is perhaps the single most important factor in eradicating poverty and promoting development." — Kofi Annan*
45	**Ethical Governance**	*"Ethics thrives on freedom, and freedom is the very essence of our humanity." — Kofi Annan*
46	**Constitutional Morality**	*"Constitutional morality is not a natural sentiment. It has to be cultivated. We must realise that our people have yet to learn it." — Dr. B.R. Ambedkar*
47	**Citizen'S Charter**	*"The Citizen's Charter is about giving more power to the citizen." — John Major*
48	**Right To Information**	*"Information is the currency of democracy." — Thomas Jefferson*
49	**Code Of Ethics Vs Code Of Conduct**	*"Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have a right to do and what is right to do." — Potter Stewart (UPSC 2022)*
50	**Conflict Of Interest**	*"No man can serve two masters." — Jesus Christ*
51	**Rights Theory (Libertarianism)**	*"Every man has a property in his own person; this nobody has a right to but himself." — John Locke*
52	**Ethical Egoism**	*"The purpose of morality is to teach you, not to suffer and die, but to enjoy yourself and live." — Ayn Rand*
53	**Determinants Of Ethics**	*"God has no religion." — Mahatma Gandhi*
54	**Descriptive Ethics**	*"It is the mark of an educated mind to entertain a thought without accepting it." — Aristotle*

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#	TERM	QUOTE
55	**Metaethics**	*"No one does wrong willingly." — Socrates*
56	**Kohlberg'S Stages Of Moral Development**	*"One has not only a legal but a moral responsibility to obey just laws. Conversely, one has a moral responsibility to disobey unjust laws." — Martin Luther King Jr.*
57	**Utilitarianism**	*"The greatest happiness of the greatest number is the foundation of morals and legislation." — Jeremy Bentham*
58	**Deontological Ethics**	*"Act only on that maxim whereby you can at the same time will that it should become a universal law." — Immanuel Kant*
59	**Virtue Ethics**	*"We are what we repeatedly do. Excellence, then, is not an act but a habit." — Aristotle (paraphrasing the Nicomachean Ethics)*
60	**Categorical Imperative**	*"Human beings should be treated as ends, never merely as means." — Immanuel Kant (UPSC 2014)*
61	**Consequentialism**	*"The true rule, in determining to embrace or reject anything, is not whether it have any evil in it, but whether it have more of evil than of good." — Abraham Lincoln (UPSC 2018)*
62	**Moral Relativism**	*"When in Rome, do as the Romans do." — St. Ambrose*
63	**Ahimsa**	*"Non-violence is the greatest force at the disposal of mankind. It is mightier than the mightiest weapon of destruction devised by the ingenuity of man." — Mahatma Gandhi*
64	**Satyagraha**	*"Satyagraha vindicates truth by the infliction of suffering not on the opponent but on oneself." — Mahatma Gandhi*
65	**Trusteeship**	*"The rich should hold their riches in trust for the welfare of the poor." — Mahatma Gandhi*
66	**Sarvodaya**	*"The good of the individual is contained in the good of all." — Mahatma Gandhi (UPSC 2013)*
67	**Nishkama Karma**	*"You have a right to perform your prescribed duty, but you are not entitled to the fruits of action." — Bhagavad Gita 2.47*
68	**Swadharma**	*"Better is one's own duty, though imperfectly performed, than the duty of another well discharged." — Bhagavad Gita 3.35*
69	**Karma Yoga**	*"Work is worship." — Swami Vivekananda*
70	**Gender Sensitization**	*"Gender equality is more than a goal in itself. It is a precondition for meeting the challenge of reducing poverty." — Kofi Annan*
71	**Environmental Ethics**	*"The environment and the economy are really both two sides of the same coin. If we cannot sustain the environment, we cannot sustain ourselves." — Wangari Maathai*
72	**Cyber Ethics**	*"The Internet is becoming the town square for the global village of tomorrow." — Bill Gates*
73	**Corporate Social Responsibility**	*"The social responsibility of business is to increase its profits — so long as it stays within the rules of the game." — Milton Friedman*

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3 · WHICH TERMS TO REACH FOR

Questions repeat by type, not by topic. Learn the cluster, and you walk in with a structure already built.

QUESTION TYPE	TERMS TO USE	THE MOVE THAT SCORES
A corruption or bribery case study	Probity (4) · Integrity (2) · Conflict of Interest (50) · Whistleblowing (38) · Accountability (37) · Transparency (36) · RTI (48)	*Anchor on probity, then show the system fix — transparency and disclosure — not just the individual's virtue.*
Pressure from a senior, a minister or a local strongman	Moral Courage (10) · Integrity (2) · Non-partisanship (8) · Crisis of Conscience (13) · Rule of Law (42) · Obedience (22)	*Name the lawful route first — written orders, recording dissent in the file — before you reach for heroism.*
Disaster, crisis or emergency response	Emotional Intelligence (27) · Empathy (30) · Compassion (31) · Fortitude (11) · Cooperation (26) · Dedication (14)	*Silkyara for what works, Meghalaya for what does not. Coordination is the examinable point.*
Development versus environment or displacement	Ethical Dilemma (34) · Environmental Ethics (71) · Utilitarianism (57) versus Deontology (58) · Public Interest (41) · Sarvodaya (66)	*Frame it as right versus right. Then decide, and say who bears the cost of your decision.*
Technology, AI, data and privacy	Cyber Ethics (72) · Rights Theory (51) · Prejudice (32, algorithmic bias) · Transparency (36) · Accountability (37)	*The EU AI Act and the DPDP Act give you a live legal spine. Algorithmic bias is prejudice at scale.*
Gender, caste or discrimination	Gender Sensitization (70) · Prejudice (32) · Social Justice (43) · Constitutional Morality (46) · Empathy (30)	*Attitude first, law second. NFHS-5 shows exactly why the law alone will not close the gap.*
A quotation-based or philosophical question	Determinants of Ethics (53) · Virtue Ethics (59) · Conscience (12) · Kohlberg (56) · Categorical Imperative (60)	*Unpack the quote, take a position, then defend it with one theory and one concrete example.*
Corporate or private-sector ethics	CSR (73) · Trusteeship (65) · Ethical Egoism (52) · Conflict of Interest (50) · Whistleblowing (38)	*Friedman versus Gandhi is the cleanest opposition available to you. Use it.*
Attitude, persuasion and behaviour change	Persuasion (23) · Conformity (21) · Socialization (20) · Cognitive Dissonance (33) · Bureaucratic vs Democratic Attitude (24)	*Swachh Bharat and the vaccination drive are the two Indian cases that carry any behaviour-change answer.*

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4 · ACTIVE RECALL TRACKER

Cover the notes. For each term, say aloud: the definition in one line, one administrative example, one contemporary example, and one quote. Tick only if you produced all four. Anything you cannot tick on the third pass is what you revise the night before.

#	TERM	DAY 1	DAY 7	DAY 21
1	Aptitude			
2	Integrity			
3	Intellectual Integrity			
4	Probity			
5	Honesty			
6	Objectivity			
7	Impartiality			
8	Non-Partisanship			
9	Tolerance			
10	Courage And Fearlessness			
11	Fortitude			
12	Conscience			
13	Crisis Of Conscience			
14	Dedication To Public Service			
15	Altruism			
16	Forbearance			
17	Trustworthiness And Public Trust			
18	Sportsmanship			
19	Duty Vs Obligation			
20	Socialization And Its Agencies			
21	Conformity			
22	Obedience			
23	Persuasion			
24	Bureaucratic Vs Democratic Attitude			
25	Intuition			
26	Cooperation			
27	Emotional Intelligence			
28	Self-Awareness			
29	Self-Regulation			
30	Empathy			

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#	TERM	DAY 1	DAY 7	DAY 21
31	Compassion			
32	Prejudice			
33	Cognitive Dissonance			
34	Ethical Dilemma			
35	Hatred And Intolerance			
36	Transparency			
37	Accountability			
38	Whistleblowing			
39	Corruption			
40	Nepotism			
41	Public Interest			
42	Rule Of Law			
43	Social Justice			
44	Good Governance			
45	Ethical Governance			
46	Constitutional Morality			
47	Citizen'S Charter			
48	Right To Information			
49	Code Of Ethics Vs Code Of Conduct			
50	Conflict Of Interest			
51	Rights Theory (Libertarianism)			
52	Ethical Egoism			
53	Determinants Of Ethics			
54	Descriptive Ethics			
55	Metaethics			
56	Kohlberg'S Stages Of Moral Development			
57	Utilitarianism			
58	Deontological Ethics			
59	Virtue Ethics			
60	Categorical Imperative			
61	Consequentialism			
62	Moral Relativism			
63	Ahimsa			

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#	TERM	DAY 1	DAY 7	DAY 21
64	Satyagraha			
65	Trusteeship			
66	Sarvodaya			
67	Nishkama Karma			
68	Swadharma			
69	Karma Yoga			
70	Gender Sensitization			
71	Environmental Ethics			
72	Cyber Ethics			
73	Corporate Social Responsibility			

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